

US WEEKLY KICKSTART

The impact of the AI capex boom on S&P 500 return on equity

- **Following a volatile week, the S&P 500 has returned 9% YTD but trades at the same 21x P/E multiple as it did a year ago.** The S&P 500 YTD return reflects a 17% rise in consensus forward 12-month earnings estimates alongside a 7% decline in the P/E multiple, from 22x to 21x. The current 21x P/E ranks in the 87th percentile since 1980. Going forward, we expect earnings growth will continue to drive the S&P 500. Within the market, recent Momentum factor volatility has tracked with the historical precedent following sharp rallies.
- **Record profitability has been one of the factors supporting high S&P 500 valuations.** S&P 500 trailing 4-quarter ROE registers a record high 22%. Whether S&P 500 valuations revert toward their long-term average or prove structurally higher going forward will depend in part on the trajectory of corporate profitability. In our macro model, every 1 percentage point change in S&P 500 ROE is associated with about a 1x turn in S&P 500 P/E. Differences in profitability also help explain the variation in valuations across equity indices.
- **S&P 500 ROE has surged by 150 bp during the past four quarters, driven by a boost from the mega-cap technology stocks to index profit margins.** Among DuPont components, rising S&P 500 profit margins have also been the primary driver of the index's 800 bp ROE expansion since 1985. In recent quarters, ROE for the aggregate S&P 500 has benefited from the growing weight of the mega-cap tech stocks while ROE for the median S&P 500 company has declined. The seven largest tech stocks currently have a collective ROE of 44%, which has expanded by 900 bp during the past three years.
- **The AI capex boom has lifted semiconductor profitability but will be an increasing headwind to mega-cap tech ROE going forward.** The hyperscalers have grown in asset intensity and experienced declining sales/asset turnover since the start of the AI boom. During the next few years, rising hyperscaler depreciation expenses will reverse some of the S&P 500 ROE benefit that AI capex has generated in the form of elevated semiconductor profit margins. Equity raises to fund investment spending will also pressure ROE. Consensus estimates imply that ROE for the seven largest technology stocks will decline by an average of 700 bp next year.
- **AI also creates a key long-term upside case for ROE, both for the mega-cap tech stocks and for the broad equity market.** For the hyperscalers, the net impact of the AI capex boom on profitability will depend on the magnitude of

Ben Snider

+1(212)357-1744 | ben.snider@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Ryan Hammond

+1(212)902-5625 |
ryan.hammond@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Jenny Ma

+1(212)357-5775 | jenny.ma@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Daniel Chavez

+1(212)357-7657 |
daniel.chavez@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Kartik Jayachandran

+1(212)855-7744 |
kartik.jayachandran@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Christophe Sung

+1(212)902-3841 |
christophe.sung@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

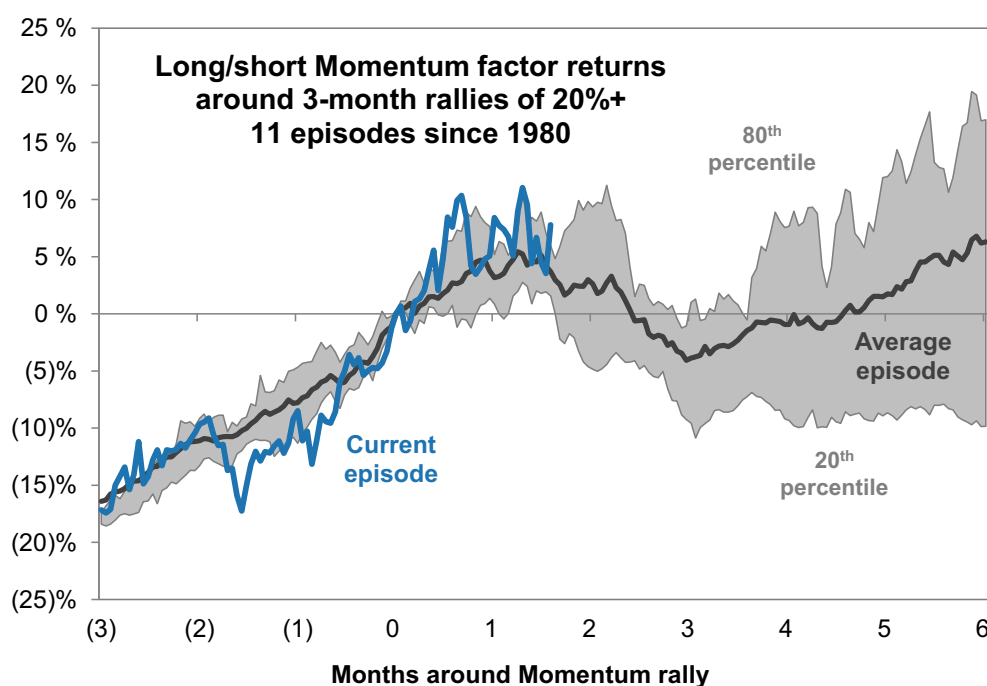
returns on their investments. For the rest of the market, AI-related productivity gains should eventually lift ROE via higher asset turnover and potentially higher profit margins. However, the share of AI-related economic gains that accrue to companies will depend on a number of factors, including government tax policy. Falling effective tax rates have helped lift S&P 500 ROE during the past few decades, but the corporate profit share of US GDP is now at the highest level since 1950.

- **We rebalance our ROE Growth basket (GSTHGROE) in this report.** The basket includes the 50 stocks with the highest consensus ROE growth during the next 12 months.

The outlook for S&P 500 ROE

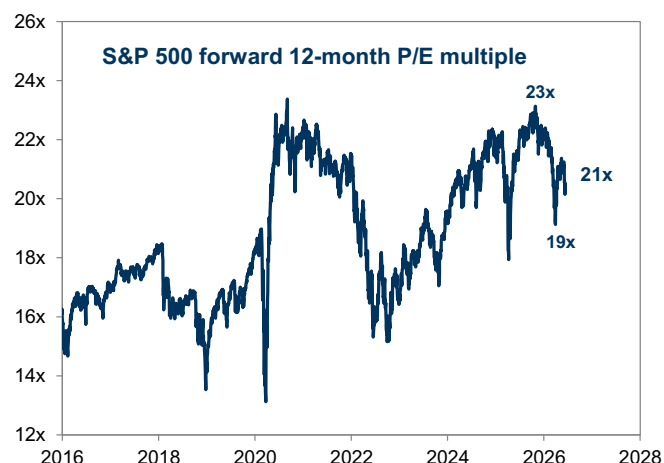
Volatile market rotations during the past week continued to follow the pattern of the sharpest Momentum rallies in recent decades. Before the sell-off that started last week, a narrow-breadth Momentum rally had driven the sharpest two-month S&P 500 return since 1971, when scaled relative to volatility. Following similarly sharp rallies in the past, the Momentum factor has usually struggled during the subsequent few months. In addition to the historical precedent, the current market characteristics of elevated trading leverage, still-narrow market breadth ([Exhibit 36](#)), and uncertainty about both the macro outlook and the AI build-out suggest volatility will persist.

Exhibit 1: Momentum has been volatile following its sharp rally earlier this year

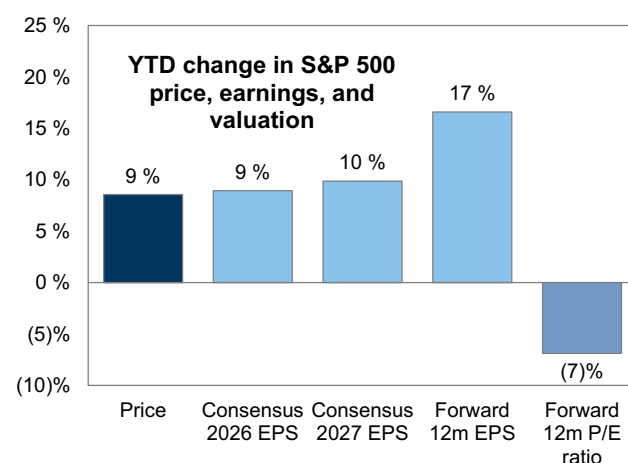


Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The S&P 500 P/E multiple has declined during the past few months but remains elevated versus history. The S&P 500 trades at 21x forward earnings, in the 87th percentile since 1980 but 11% below the peak of 23x in late 2025. The median S&P 500 stock trades at 18x, also high by historical standards but in line with the last several years.

Exhibit 2: S&P 500 NTM P/E is 11% below late 2025 peak

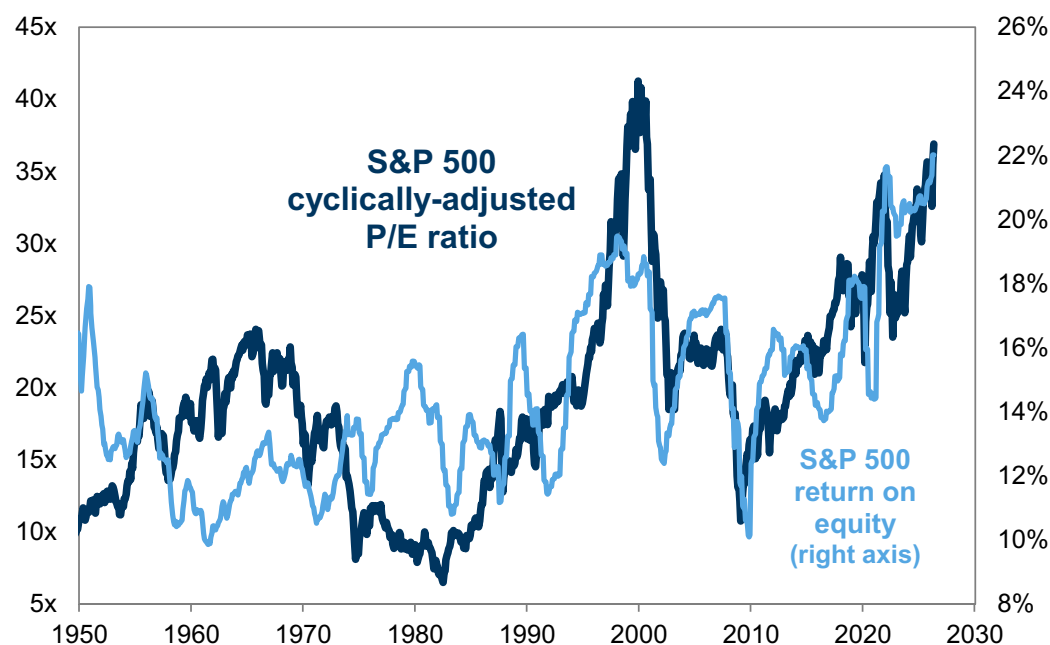
Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: S&P 500 forward P/E has contracted YTD

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

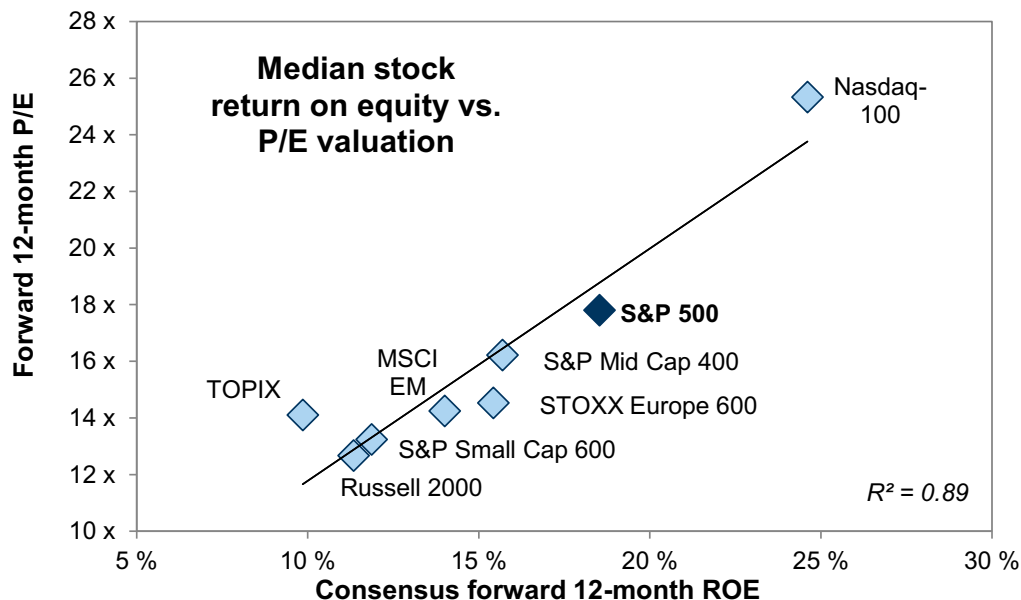
Record profitability has been one of the factors supporting high S&P 500 valuations.

The current S&P 500 trailing 4-quarter return on equity ("ROE") is 22%, the highest on record. Although the P/E is elevated relative to history, it is roughly in line with the fair value indicated by our macro models. Just as investors typically assign higher valuation multiples to stocks with higher profitability, history suggests that the profitability of the aggregate equity market helps determine its P/E multiple, along with macro factors like interest rates and inflation.

Exhibit 4: Higher ROE has supported higher P/E multiples

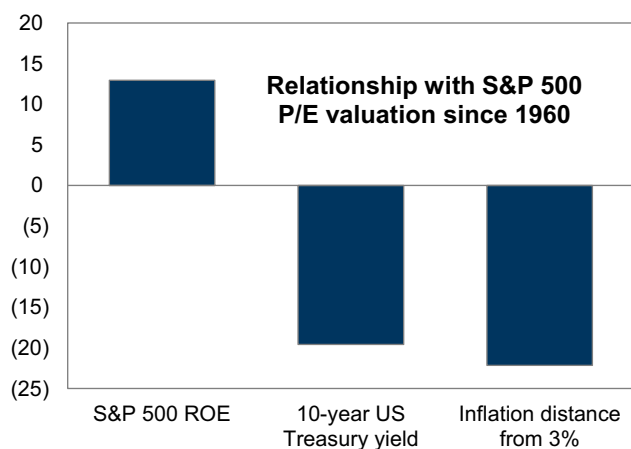
Source: Robert Shiller, Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Variation in profitability also helps explain the variation in valuations across equity indices. The relationship between ROE and P/E valuation multiples is evident both among US equity indices and across a selection of major global indices.

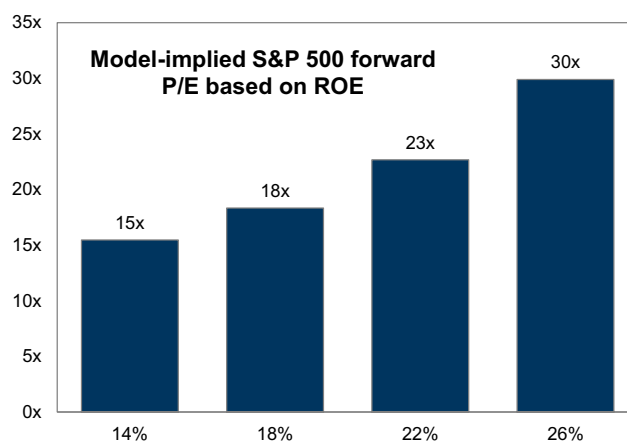
Exhibit 5: Difference in profitability helps explain variation in valuations across equity indices


Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Whether S&P 500 valuations revert toward their long-term average or prove structurally higher going forward will depend in large part on the trajectory of corporate profitability. Based on our macro model, every 1 percentage point change in S&P 500 ROE is associated with a change of roughly 1x in S&P 500 P/E.

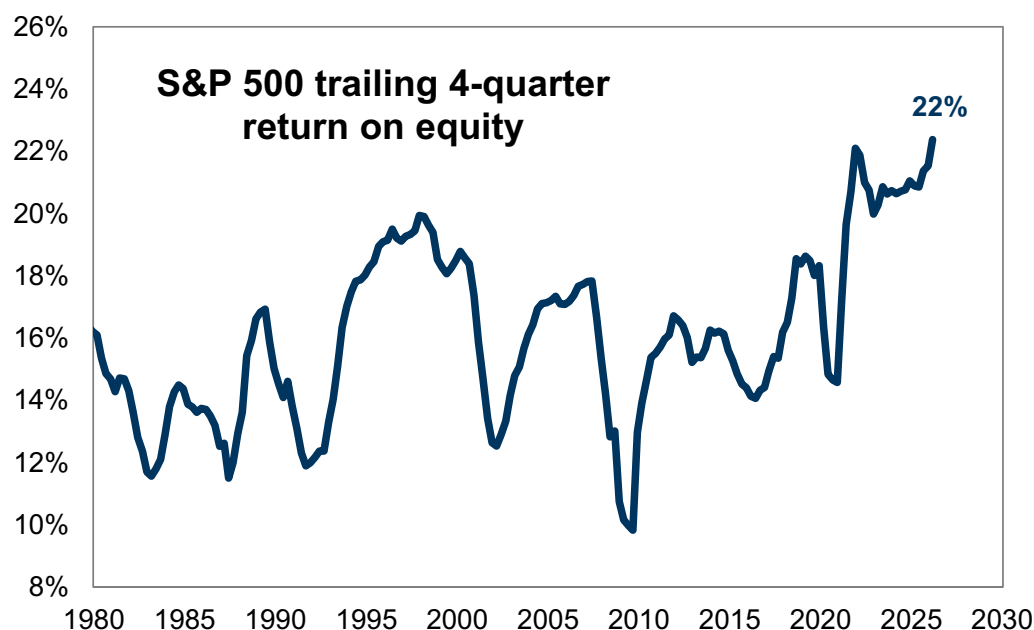
Exhibit 6: Drivers of our macro model of S&P 500 valuation


Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: Sensitivity of S&P 500 valuation to ROE
 assumes constant inflation and interest rates


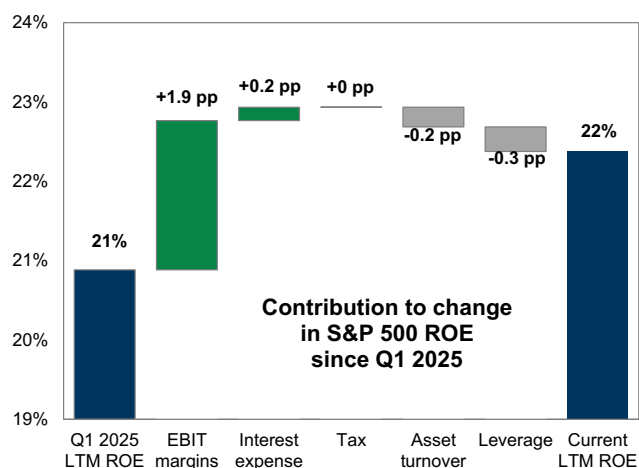
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

S&P 500 trailing 4-quarter ROE reached a record high of 22% in Q1 2026, surpassing the previous high reached in 2021. ROE rose by 150 basis points during the past four quarters. During the past 40 years, S&P 500 return on equity has expanded by 800 basis points.

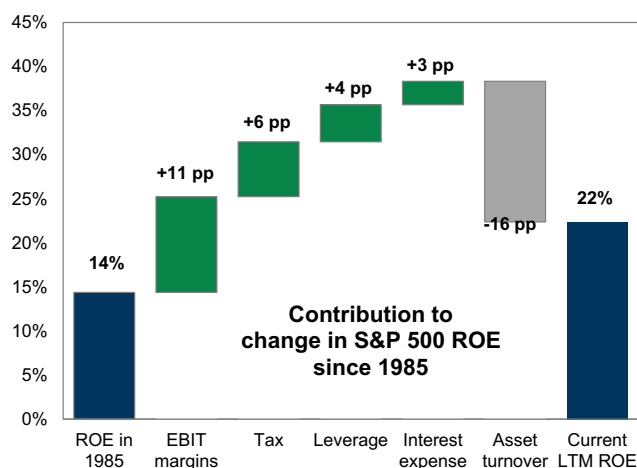
Exhibit 8: S&P 500 ROE has surged to a record high

Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

EBIT margins have been the primary driver of ROE expansion during the past year and during the past few decades. Declining tax rates and falling borrow costs have also been tailwinds to ROE. Rising corporate leverage has been a contributor to long-term S&P 500 ROE expansion but a modest detractor during the past few quarters.

Exhibit 9: Recent ROE growth decomposition

Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: Long-term ROE growth decomposition

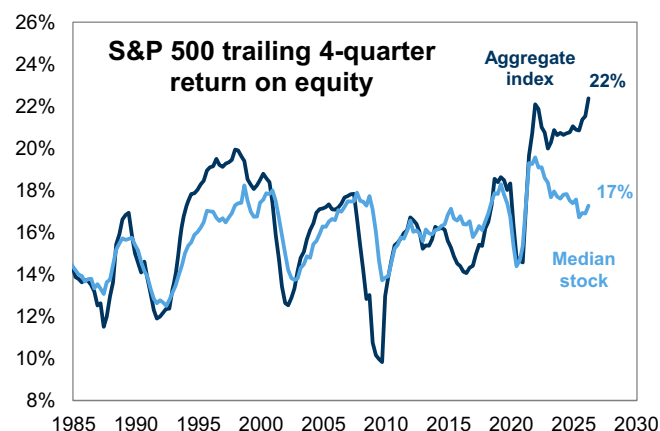
Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

In contrast with surging S&P 500 Index ROE, ROE for the median S&P 500 stock has declined during the past few years and remains below previous highs. Since 1985, ROE for the median S&P 500 company has expanded from 14% to 17%. However, during the past few years, ROE for the median stock has declined due to a combination of higher interest expense, lower leverage, and modestly higher tax expense.

ROE for the aggregate S&P 500 has benefited from the growing weight of mega-cap

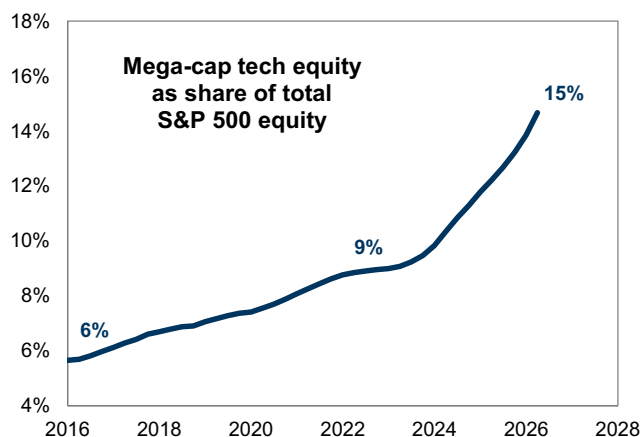
tech stocks, which generate above-average profitability. ROE for the seven largest stocks in the S&P 500 (NVDA, AAPL, GOOGL, MSFT, AMZN, AVGO, and META) currently registers a collective 44% and has expanded by 9 pp during the past three years ([Exhibit 13](#)).

Exhibit 11: Divergence between aggregate and median stock ROE



Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: The share of S&P 500 equity attributable to mega-cap tech has more than doubled during the past decade

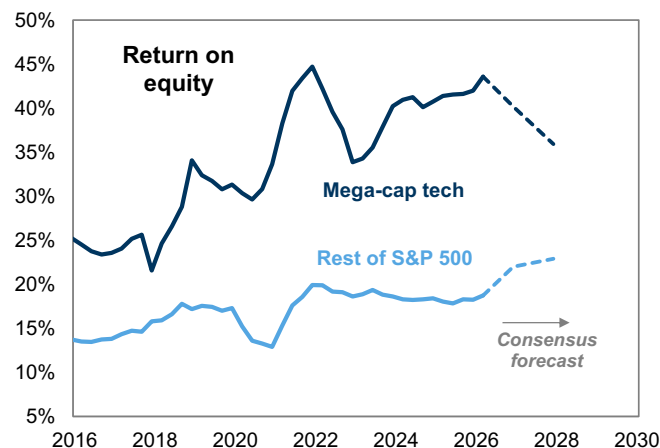


Mega-cap tech = AAPL, AMZN, AVGO, GOOGL, META, MSFT, NVDA

Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The AI capex boom is likely to weigh on ROE for the mega-cap tech stocks in coming years. While ROE for the mega-cap tech stocks is extremely elevated, the forward outlook faces increasing challenges. Consensus estimates suggest each of the mega-cap tech stocks will experience declining ROEs next year, by an average of 7 pp.

Exhibit 13: ROE for mega-cap tech and the rest of the S&P 500



Mega-cap tech = AAPL, AMZN, AVGO, GOOGL, META, MSFT, NVDA

Source: Compustat, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: Consensus estimates point to declining ROE for mega-cap tech

	ROE (consensus)			2027 vs. 2026
	2025	2026	2027	
AVGO	43 %	51 %	51 %	(0)pp
AMZN	19	18	16	(2)
MSFT	29	26	24	(2)
META	28	28	23	(5)
GOOGL	32	30	24	(6)
NVDA	74	72	61	(12)
AAPL	140	109	83	(26)
Average				(7)pp

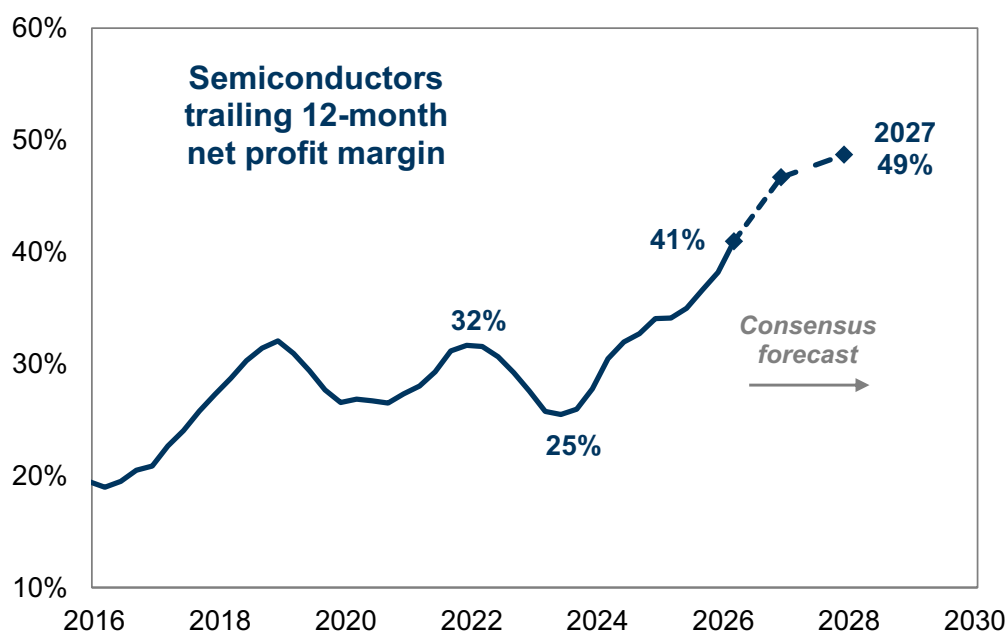
Based on calendar years

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The demand for chips has pushed semiconductor profitability to extremely high levels, but investors remain skeptical about the durability of those earnings. The largest direct earnings beneficiaries of the AI capex boom have been semiconductor

firms. Strong moats and a shortfall of supply relative to demand have given these semiconductor firms strong pricing power, boosting their margins and lifting ROE. However, investors fear the combination of slowing demand and increasing supply, including from new competitors, will eventually weigh on semiconductor profitability. Analyst forecasts imply that semiconductor companies will largely be able to defend profit margins during the next year, but their estimates imply a decline in ROE as growth in equity outpaces growth in earnings.

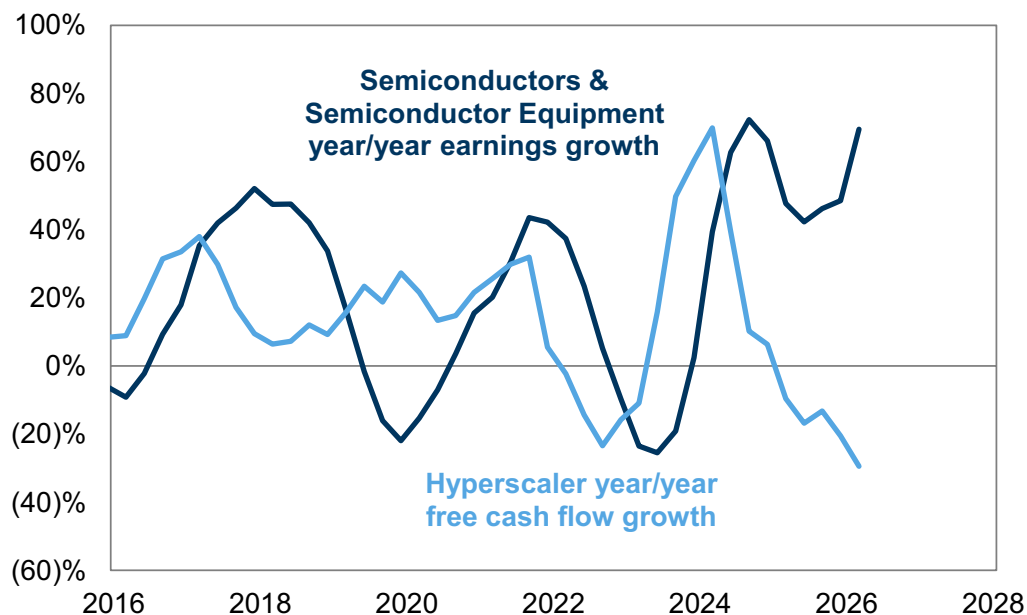
Exhibit 15: Semiconductor margins have climbed to a record high



Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The capex boom boosting semiconductor earnings today will weigh on hyperscaler ROE going forward as depreciation expenses build. Analyst estimates imply that depreciation and amortization will climb from 7% of hyperscaler revenues in 2022 to 12% in 2027 ([Exhibit 17](#)).

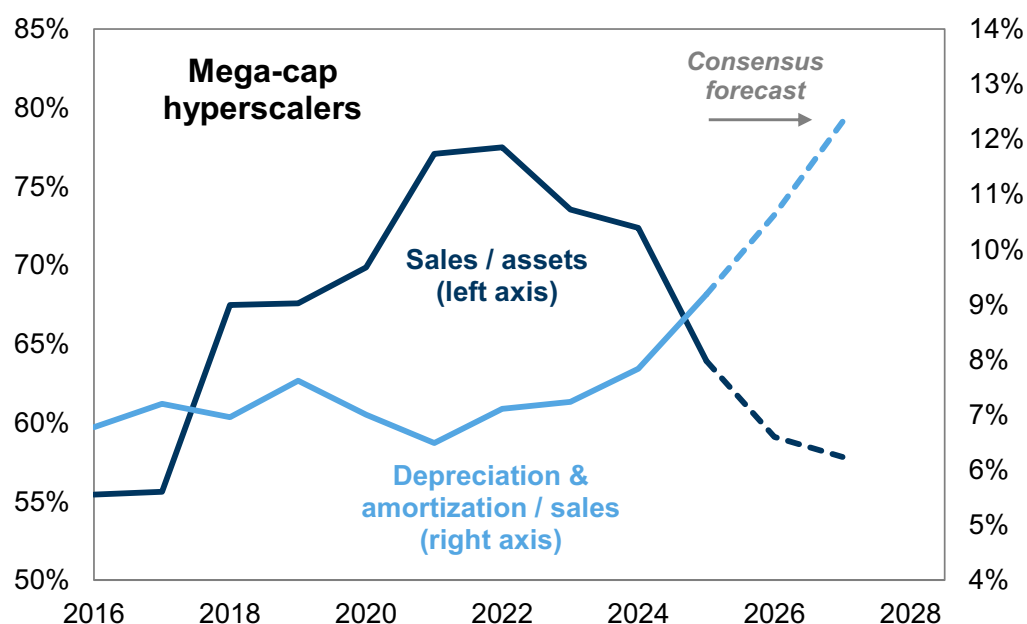
Exhibit 16: Semiconductor earnings have risen at the expense of hyperscaler free cash flows
trailing 4-quarter earnings and free cash flows



Hyperscalers = AMZN, GOOGL, META, MSFT, ORCL

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The hyperscalers have also become increasingly asset-heavy businesses. For the decade prior to AI capex build-out, the asset-light business models of the hyperscalers were reflected in rising sales/asset ratios, supporting ROE expansion. However, the physical footprint required to support AI workloads has led to a steady decline in asset turnover, which analysts expect will continue in 2027.

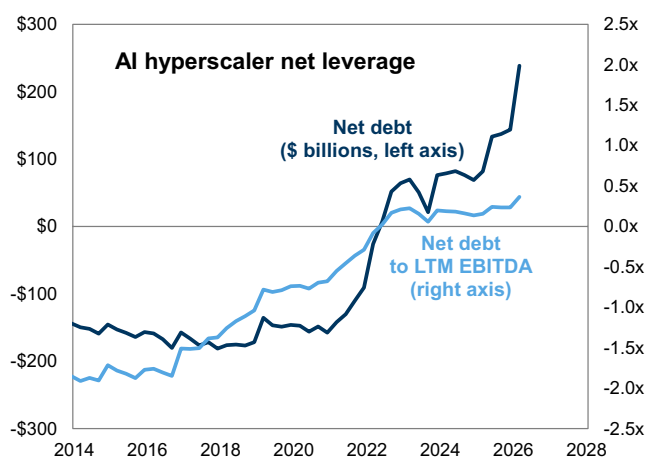
Exhibit 17: AI hyperscaler capex will create headwinds to ROE

Hyperscalers = AMZN, META, MSFT, GOOGL, ORCL

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

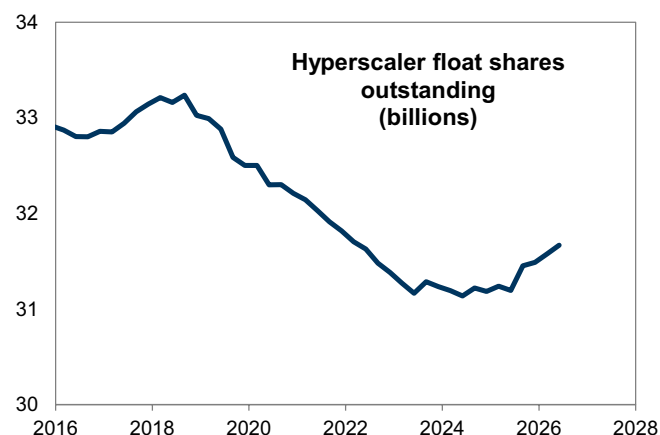
Capital raising to fund the AI build-out signals additional headwinds to ROE.

Consensus estimates suggest the hyperscalers will spend \$770 billion on capex in 2026, equivalent to 100% of cash flows from operations. In order to fund continued capex growth, the companies have increasingly turned to debt and equity issuance and pulled back on buybacks. Net debt for the hyperscalers has increased by \$170 billion since start of 2025 and share counts have begun to rise. While further increases in corporate leverage would support ROE expansion going forward, all else equal, higher leverage would also likely result in increased interest expenses, weighing on ROE.

Exhibit 18: Hyperscaler net leverage has been rising

Hyperscalers = AMZN, GOOGL, META, MSFT, ORCL

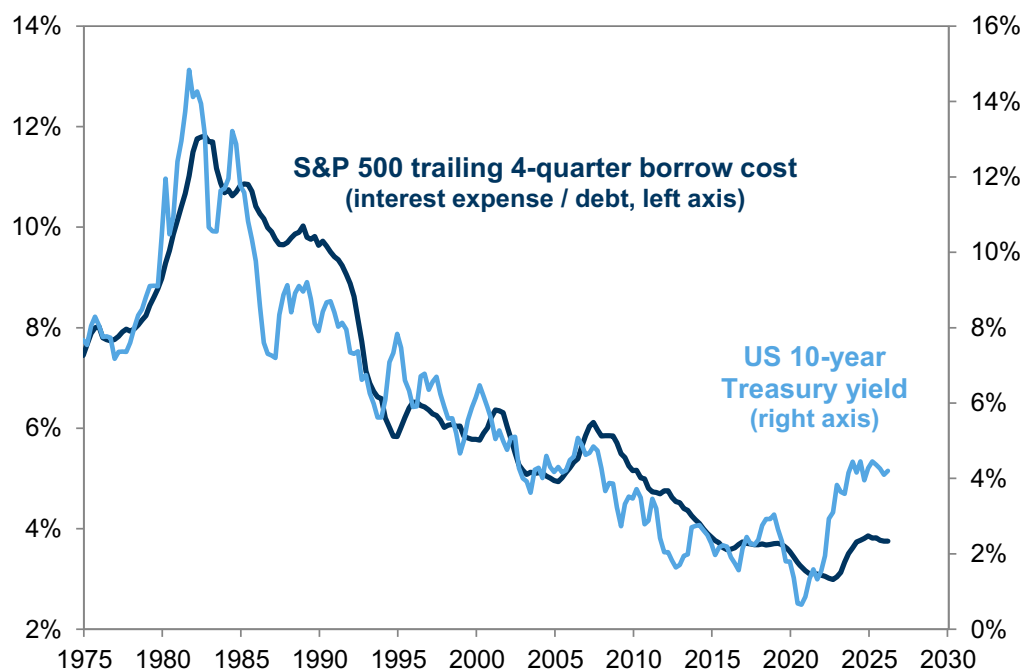
Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: Hyperscaler shares outstanding have grown in recent quarters

Hyperscalers = AMZN, GOOGL, META, MSFT, ORCL

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

S&P 500 borrow costs have risen only modestly during the past few years relative to the increase in Treasury yields. However, the increase in bond yields raises the cost of financing for new issuance, in turn pressuring profitability.

Exhibit 20: S&P 500 borrow costs have increased modestly relative to the increase in bond yields

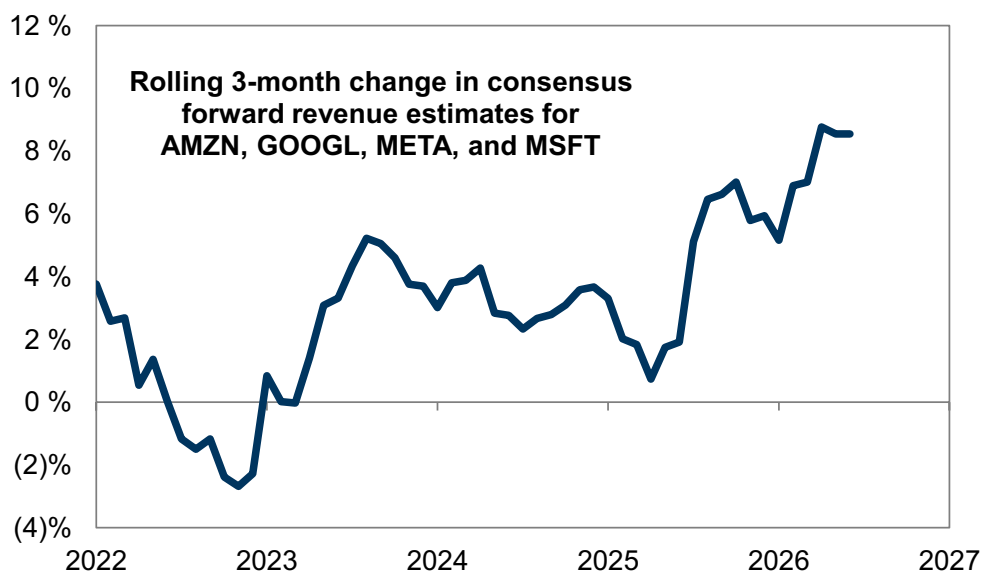
Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Despite growing headwinds, the net impact of the AI capex boom on the hyperscalers' ROE will depend on the magnitude of returns on their investments.

The Q1 earnings season offered evidence of the hyperscalers' ability to monetize AI, with positive revenue revisions, large backlogs, and rising gross margins. Our equity analysts

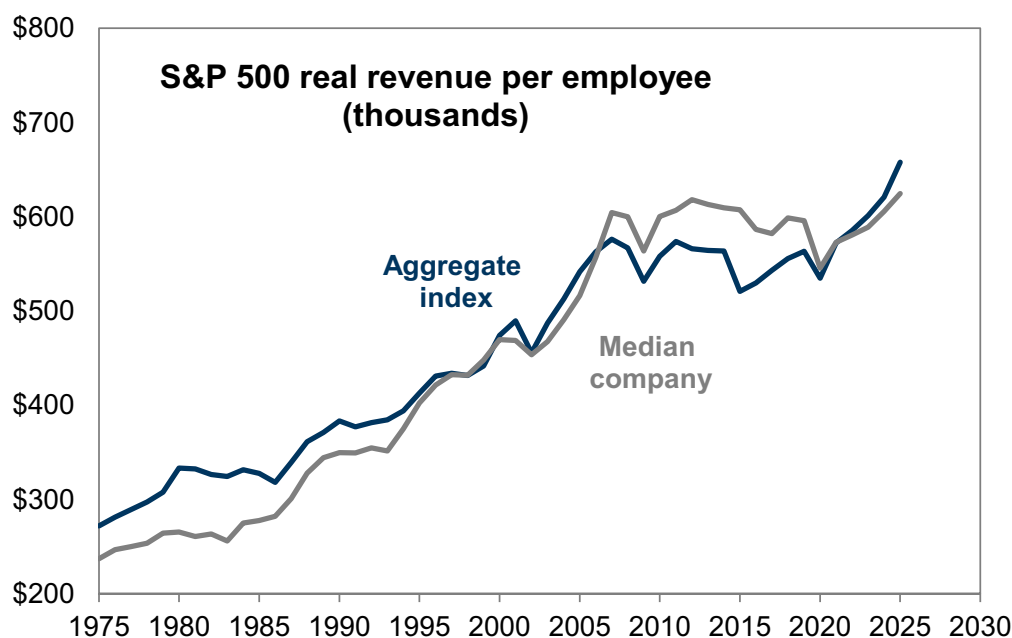
also expect an inflection in token economics ahead for hyperscalers and model providers, enabled by stabilizing token prices but falling compute cost per token.

Exhibit 21: Hyperscaler revenue estimates have been improving recently



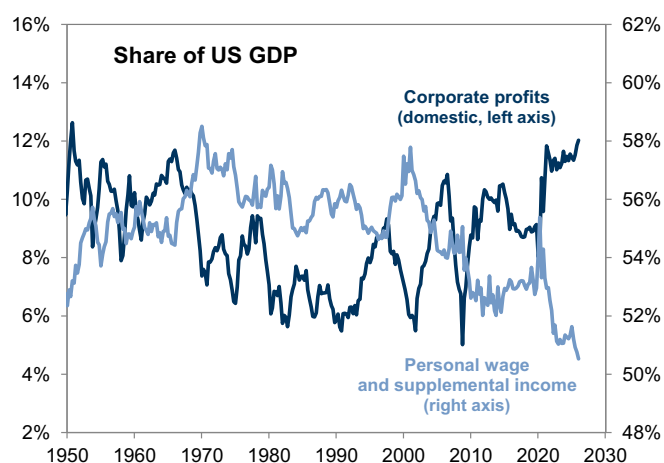
Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

For most of corporate America, AI productivity represents a potential tailwind to profitability. We remain in the early stages of enterprise AI adoption. Last quarter, roughly 54% of companies discussed AI in the context of productivity on their earnings calls, but just 11% of companies quantified the AI productivity gains on a specific use case and only 2% of companies quantified the impact of AI productivity on earnings. The majority of companies focused on cost savings and efficiencies related to AI productivity. For the average company in the index, eventual AI productivity gains should boost sales and earnings per employee, in turn lifting profitability.

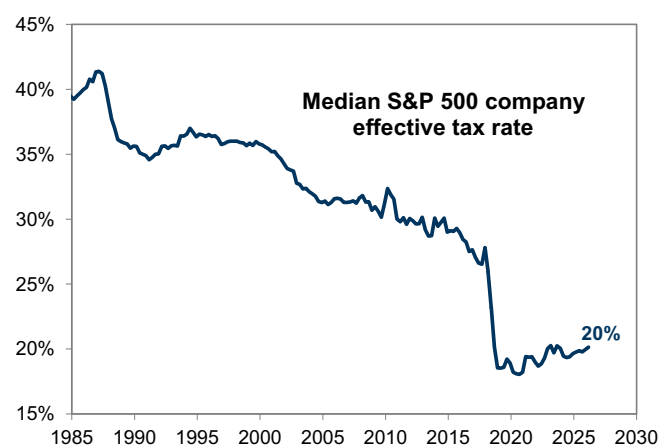
Exhibit 22: We expect AI productivity gains will eventually boost sales per employee

Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The share of AI-related productivity gains that accrue to corporate profits over the long term will depend in part on the response of government policy. Corporate profits as a share of GDP have risen to the highest level since 1950 alongside a decline in the personal income share and a multi-decade decline in the effective S&P 500 tax rate. Lower corporate tax rates have been one of the largest contributors to ROE expansion during the past 40 years.

Exhibit 23: Corporate profit share has risen

Source: US Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA), Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 24: The effective tax rate for S&P 500 companies has declined

Source: Compustat, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

We rebalance our ROE Growth basket (GSTHGROE) in this report. Our sector-neutral basket includes the 50 stocks with the highest consensus expected ROE growth during the next 12 months. The median stock in the basket has expected ROE growth of 18%

vs. 0% for the median S&P 500 stock and trades at a similar valuation.

Exhibit 25: Constituents of our ROE Growth basket (GSTHGROE)

bold indicates new constituent

						YTD		Consensus							
		Total	Price to	ROE			Total	Price to	ROE			Forward	ROE		
Company Name	Ticker	Return	Book	LTM	Forward	ROE Growth	Return	Book	LTM	Forward	ROE Growth	ROE	ROE Growth		
COMMUNICATION SERVICES															
Paramount Skydance	PSKY	(21)%	0.9x	5 %	7 %	46 %									
Take-Two Interactive Software	TTWO	(17)	11.3	26	35	34									
T-Mobile US Inc.	TMUS	(8)	3.5	19	24	22									
News Corp.	NWSA	1	1.7	7	7	13									
AT&T Inc.	T	(5)	1.5	13	14	7									
CONSUMER DISCRETIONARY															
NIKE Inc.	NKE	(27)%	4.0x	17 %	20 %	21 %									
Ford Motor Co.	F	15	1.4	15	18	20									
DoorDash Inc.	DASH	(32)	6.5	9	11	19									
Williams-Sonoma	WSM	23	12.8	51	61	19									
Chipotle Mexican Grill	CMG	(16)	13.6	54	64	18									
CONSUMER STAPLES															
Bunge Global SA	BG	42 %	1.7x	9 %	11 %	27 %									
Archer-Daniels-Midland	ADM	39	1.7	9	10	19									
ENERGY															
Phillips 66	PSX	40 %	2.6x	15 %	21 %	38 %									
Marathon Petroleum	MPC	62	4.5	33	44	33									
FINANCIALS															
Block Inc.	XYZ	6 %	1.7x	8 %	10 %	30 %									
Citigroup Inc.	C	20	1.2	8	9	24									
Citizens Financial Group	CFG	15	1.2	8	9	20									
Global Payments	GPV	(15)	0.8	14	17	18									
Invesco Ltd.	IVZ	9	1.2	8	9	15									
KeyCorp.	KEY	10	1.4	10	12	15									
MATERIALS															
LyondellBasell Industries	LYB	50 %	1.9x	15 %	22 %	46 %									
HEALTH CARE															
Centene Corp.	CNC	54 %	1.4x	6 %	8 %	29 %									
Viatis Inc.	VTRS	33	1.2	18	20	11									
Abbott Laboratories	ABT	(28)	3.0	19	20	7									
UnitedHealth Group	UNH	24	3.8	15	16	6									
INDUSTRIALS															
CSX Corp.	CSX	31 %	6.8x	25 %	29 %	18 %									
GE Aerospace	GE	8	18.7	39	45	15									
C.H. Robinson Worldwide	CHRW	20	12.6	36	41	14									
Westinghouse Air Brake Technologies	WAB	23	4.1	15	17	13									
INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY															
Salesforce Inc.	CRM	(37)%	2.9x	24 %	34 %	43 %									
Cohesive Corp.	COHR	97	8.9	10	14	38									
Ciena Corp.	CIEN	90	22.4	24	32	33									
ON Semiconductor	ON	114	5.9	14	19	32									
Analog Devices Inc.	ADI	53	5.9	15	19	27									
Applied Materials	AMAT	116	20.5	31	39	25									
Teradyne Inc.	TER	97	20.8	28	34	23									
Texas Instruments	TXN	73	16.3	34	41	18									
Hewlett Packard Enterprise	HPE	96	2.5	14	17	18									
Corning Inc.	GLW	102	13.1	19	22	16									
Synopsys Inc.	SNPS	(3)	3.0	8	9	12									
Monolithic Power Systems	MPWR	76	21.8	25	28	11									
Broadcom Inc.	AVGO	12	22.7	47	53	11									
First Solar Inc.	FSLR	4	3.1	16	18	8									
Qnity Electronics	Q	83	3.6	10	11	7									
Trimble Inc.	TRMB	(36)	2.1	14	14	6									
Roper Technologies	ROP	(25)	1.8	11	12	5									
NXP Semiconductors	NXPI	40	7.5	30	31	5									
Keysight Technologies	KEYS	67	9.7	24	25	4									
REAL ESTATE															
CoStar Group Inc.	CSGP	(51)%	1.7x	6 %	8 %	43 %									
UTILITIES															
Sempra	SRE	4 %	1.9x	9 %	10 %	9 %									
ROE Basket Median							20 %	3.3x	15 %	18 %	18 %	18 %	0		
S&P 500 Median							6	3.3	18	18	18	0	0		

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

S&P 500 earnings and return forecasts

Pricing as of June 11, 2026, unless otherwise noted.

Exhibit 26: Goldman Sachs top-down S&P 500 forecasts



Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 27: Goldman Sachs and consensus forecasts for S&P 500 earnings and returns

	Goldman Sachs forecast	Bottom-up analyst consensus	Top-down strategist consensus
S&P 500 EPS			
2025	\$275	\$275	\$275
Y/Y growth	12 %	12 %	12 %
2026	\$340	\$341	\$320
Y/Y growth	24 %	24 %	16 %
2027	\$385	\$398	\$365
Y/Y growth	13 %	17 %	14 %
S&P 500 P/E			
Current on NTM EPS	21x	20x	22x
S&P 500 price target			
YE 2026	8000	NA	7650
Return to target	8 %		3 %
12-month	8300	8900	NA
Return to target	12 %	21 %	

Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Biggest stock movers this week

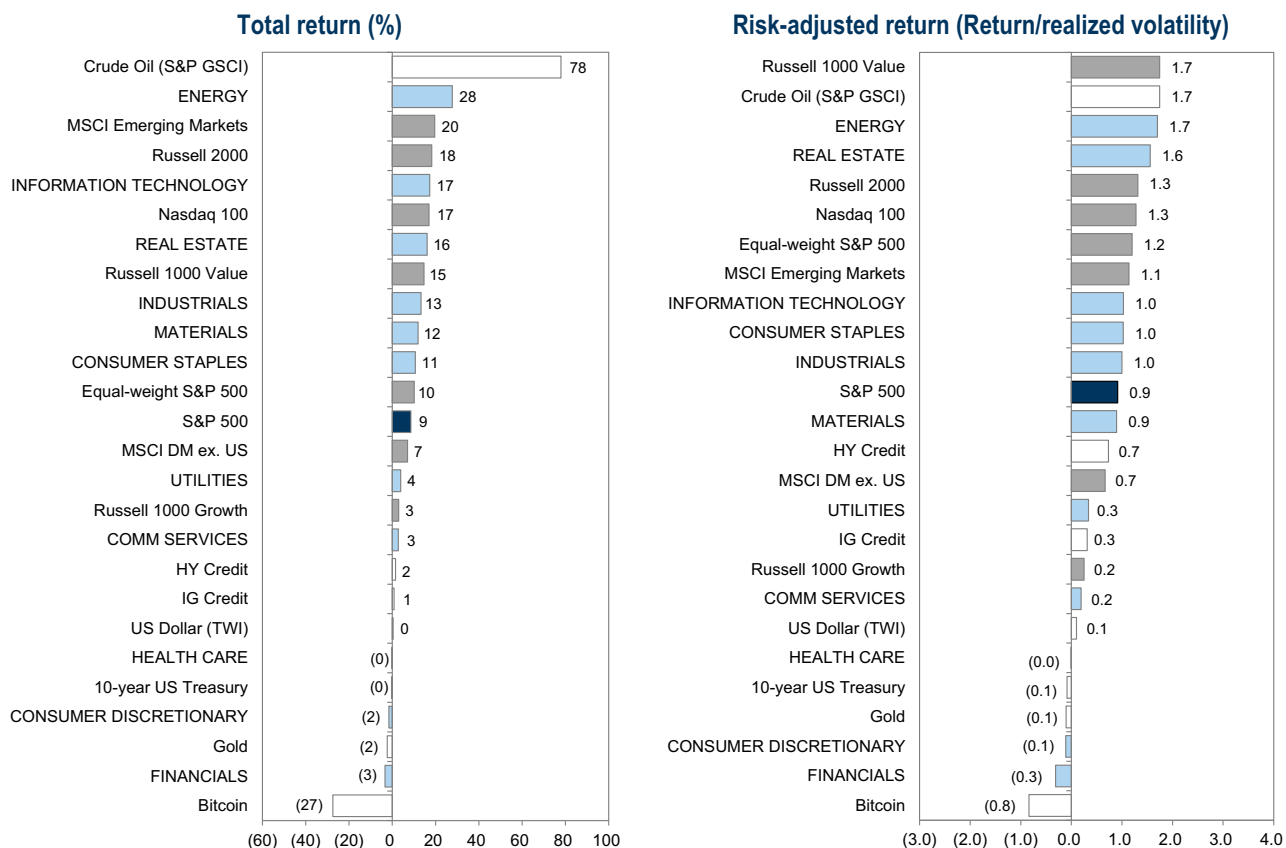
Exhibit 28: S&P 500 stocks with the largest moves this week
as of June 12, 2026

Company	Ticker	Industry group	This week	Total return			Market cap (bn)	Consensus	Fwd 12m
				3m	6m	12m		2026 EPS growth	
Top 10 returns this week									
KLA Corp.	KLAC	Semiconductors & Semi Equip	32 %	65 %	94 %	178 %	\$315	889 %	53x
Sandisk Corp.	SNDK	Tech Hardware & Equipment	27	187	679	4577	279	1871	12
Intel Corp.	INTC	Semiconductors & Semi Equip	26	144	196	466	588	173	117
Applied Materials	AMAT	Semiconductors & Semi Equip	25	58	105	222	439	44	38
Lam Research Corp.	LRCX	Semiconductors & Semi Equip	21	66	115	302	453	39	49
Casey's General Stores	CASY	Consumer Staples Retail	17	34	69	84	34	22	42
Micron Technology	MU	Semiconductors & Semi Equip	14	138	286	760	1,123	638	10
Robinhood Markets	HOOD	Financial Services	13	17	(25)	23	83	(8)	47
Teradyne Inc.	TER	Semiconductors & Semi Equip	13	26	87	341	60	83	57
J.M. Smucker	SJM	Food Beverage & Tobacco	13	10	18	27	12	16	12
Bottom 10 returns this week									
Super Micro Computer	SMCI	Tech Hardware & Equipment	(27)%	1 %	(6)%	(26)%	\$19	67 %	10x
Adobe Inc.	ADBE	Software & Services	(19)	(20)	(38)	(47)	88	11	8
PTC Inc.	PTC	Software & Services	(17)	(26)	(33)	(31)	14	(10)	15
Oracle Corp.	ORCL	Software & Services	(14)	13	(7)	5	529	9	23
Autodesk Inc.	ADSK	Software & Services	(14)	(18)	(32)	(31)	43	20	15
AppLovin Corp.	APP	Software & Services	(11)	4	(33)	25	161	64	29
Salesforce Inc.	CRM	Software & Services	(11)	(14)	(36)	(37)	136	11	12
Akamai Technologies	AKAM	Software & Services	(11)	24	55	69	19	(6)	20
Gartner Inc.	IT	Software & Services	(10)	(7)	(36)	(64)	10	1	10
GoDaddy Inc.	GDDY	Software & Services	(10)	(13)	(40)	(58)	10	14	10
Median S&P 500 stock			1 %	3 %	6 %	12 %	\$42	10 %	18x
S&P 500 Index			1	9	8	24	66,169	24	20

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

YTD absolute and risk-adjusted returns

Exhibit 29: YTD asset returns and return/volatility ratios

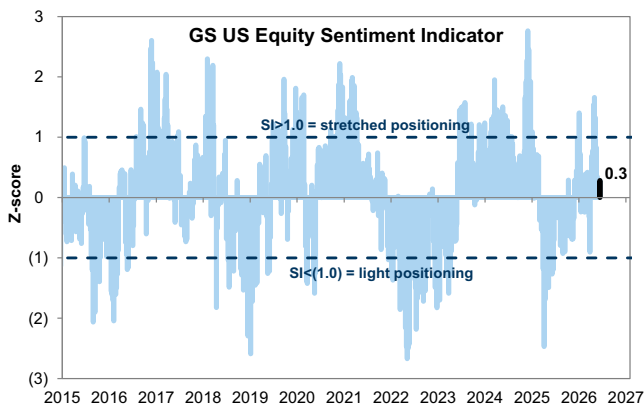


Crude oil represents S&P GSCI Crude Oil Index.

Source: FactSet, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Sentiment and flows

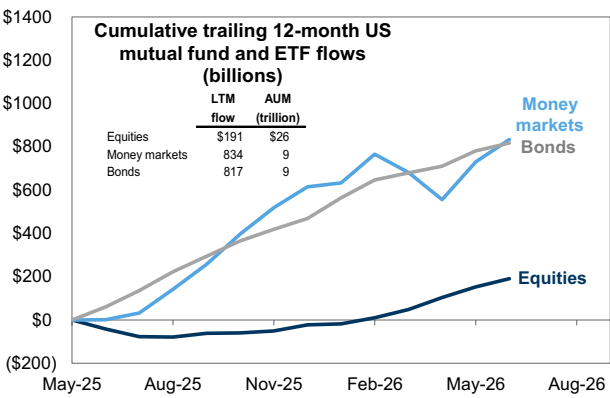
Exhibit 30: GS US Equity Sentiment Indicator of investor positioning as of June 12, 2026



The Sentiment Indicator combines 9 measures of positioning across institutional, retail, and foreign investors and has historically been a statistically significant signal for near-term S&P 500 returns.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

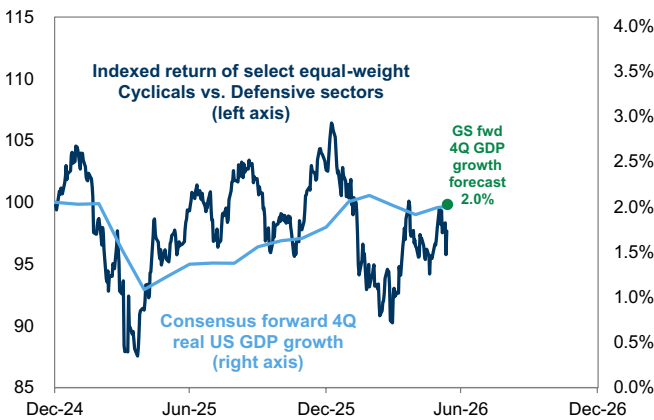
Exhibit 31: Recent mutual fund and ETF flows



Source: EPFR, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

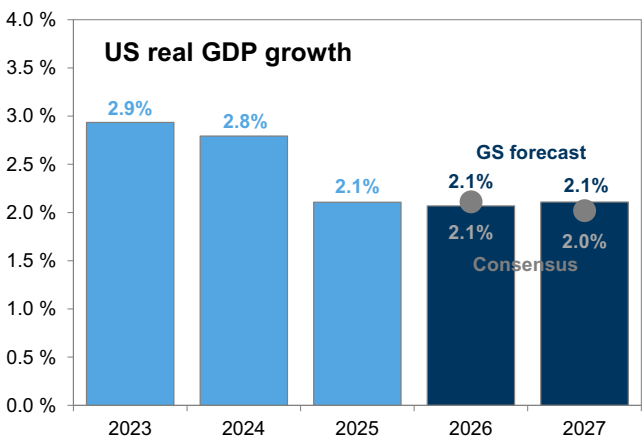
Economic growth

Exhibit 32: US equity market internal pricing of economic growth



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

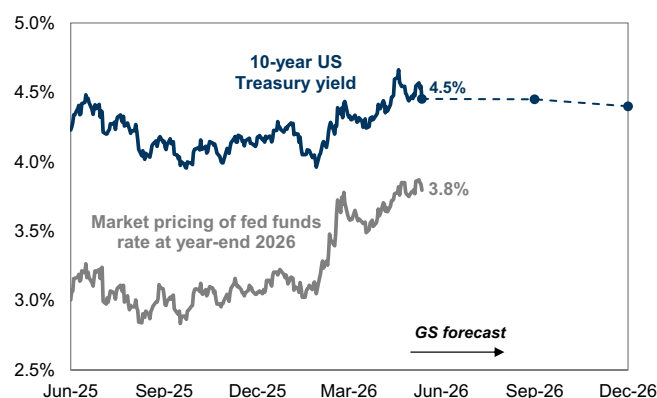
Exhibit 33: Goldman Sachs and consensus forecasts for US real GDP growth



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

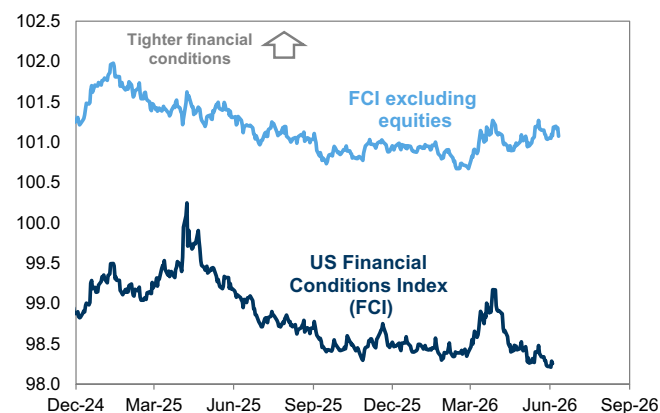
Interest rates and financial conditions

Exhibit 34: Market pricing of near-term and long-term interest rate outlook



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

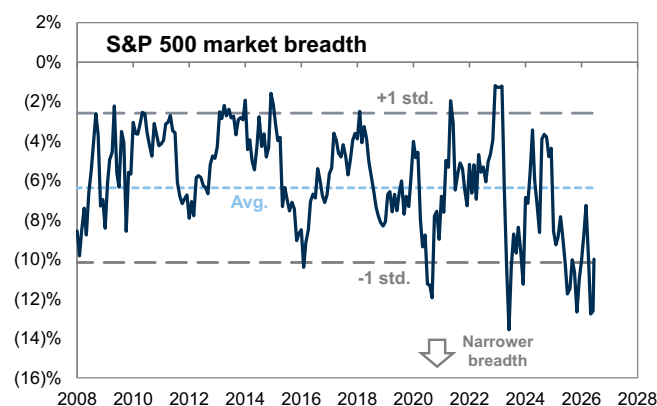
Exhibit 35: Goldman Sachs Financial Conditions Index



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Market breadth and concentration

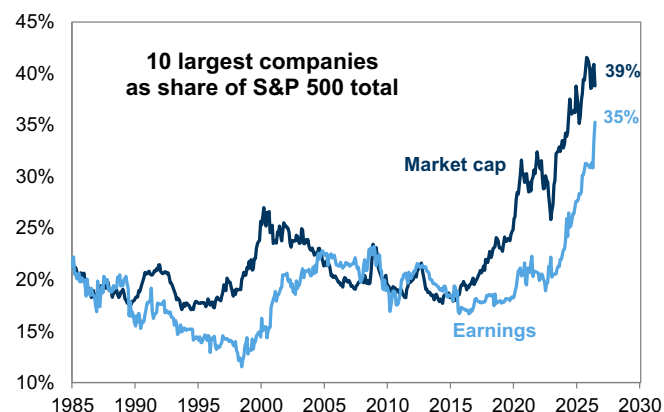
Exhibit 36: S&P 500 52-week market breadth



Market breadth calculated as the difference between the distance of the aggregate S&P 500 Index from its 52-week high and the distance of the median S&P 500 constituent from its 52-week high. When the aggregate index is much closer to its 52-week high than is the median stock, market breadth is narrow.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 37: Concentration of S&P 500 market cap and earnings in the 10 largest index constituents

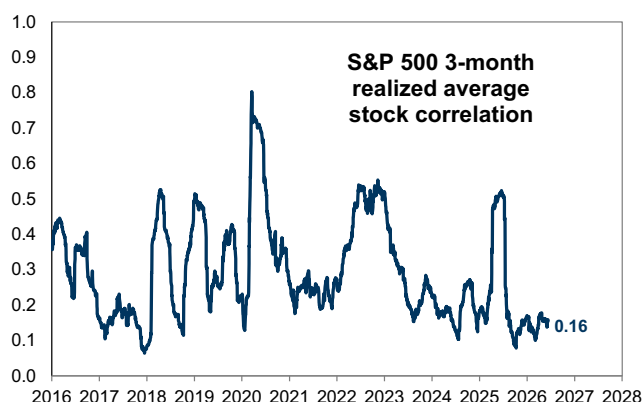


Earnings reflect consensus forward 12-month estimates.

Source: Compustat, IBES, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

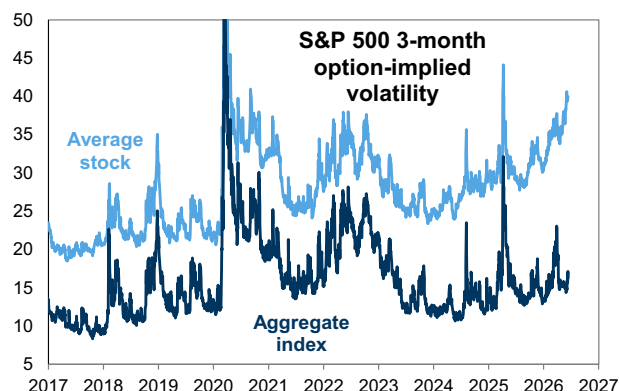
Correlation and volatility

Exhibit 38: S&P 500 realized average stock correlation



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

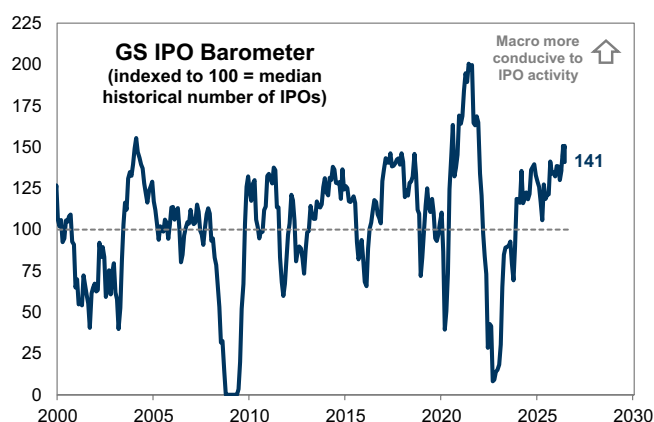
Exhibit 39: S&P 500 implied volatility



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

IPO Barometer and mutual fund performance

Exhibit 40: Goldman Sachs IPO Barometer



The Goldman Sachs IPO Barometer combines five indicators that gauge the conduciveness of the macro environment to IPO activity.

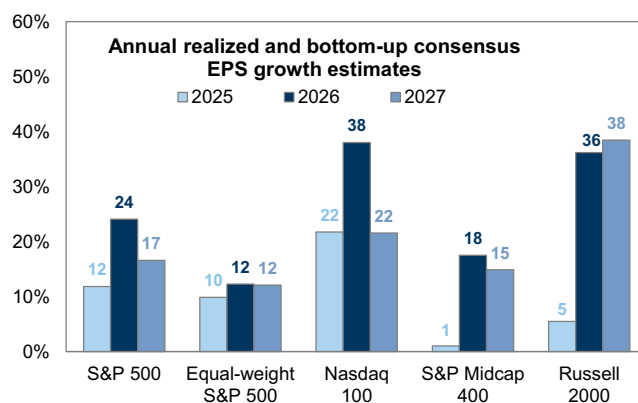
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 41: US equity mutual fund returns relative to benchmarks

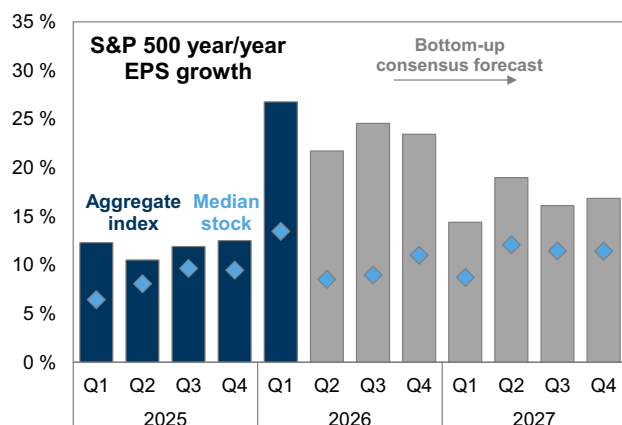
Mutual fund style	Average	% outperforming
	YTD return	benchmarks YTD
Large-cap core	8%	36%
Large-cap growth	5	63
Large-cap value	10	15
Large-cap total	7%	38%
Small-cap core	17%	33%

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

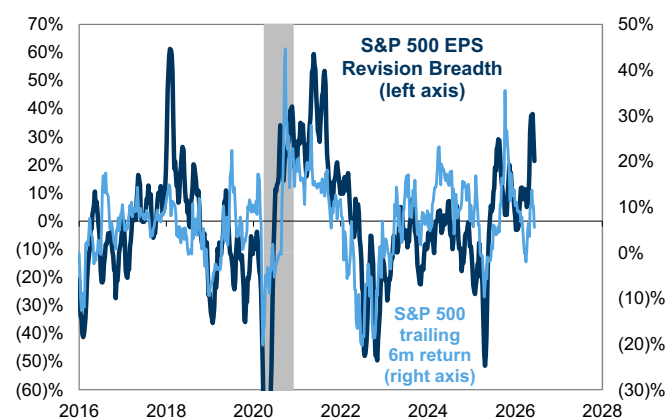
Earnings growth

Exhibit 42: Realized and consensus EPS growth for select US equity indices

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 43: Realized and consensus year/year S&P 500 EPS growth

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

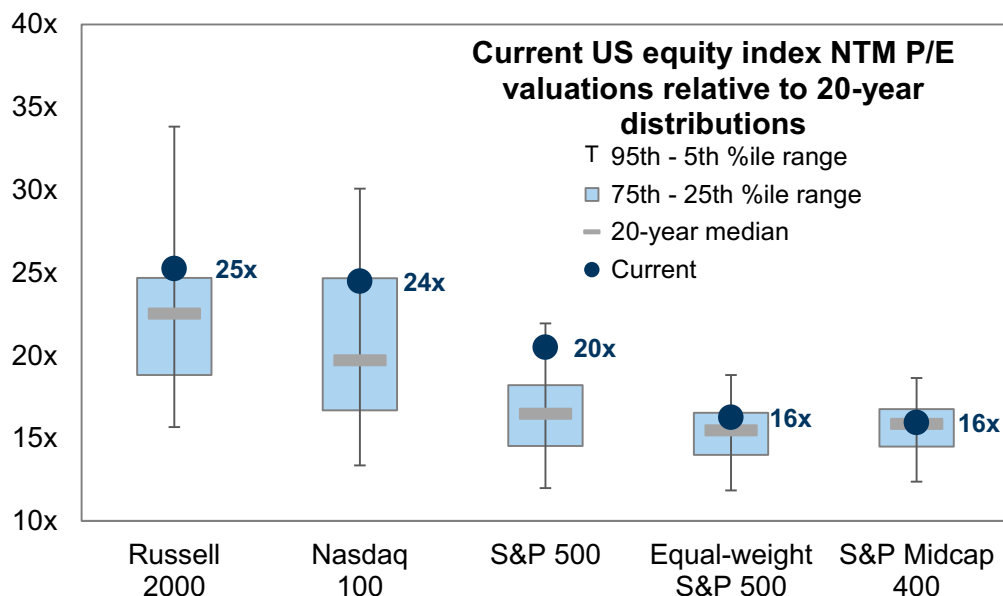
Exhibit 44: S&P 500 FY2 earnings revision breadth

Revision breadth calculated as $\frac{[(\# \text{ of companies with positive EPS revisions}) - (\# \text{ of companies with negative revisions})]}{(\text{total } \# \text{ of companies})}$. Revisions reflect FY2 EPS estimate changes during a rolling 1-month window.

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

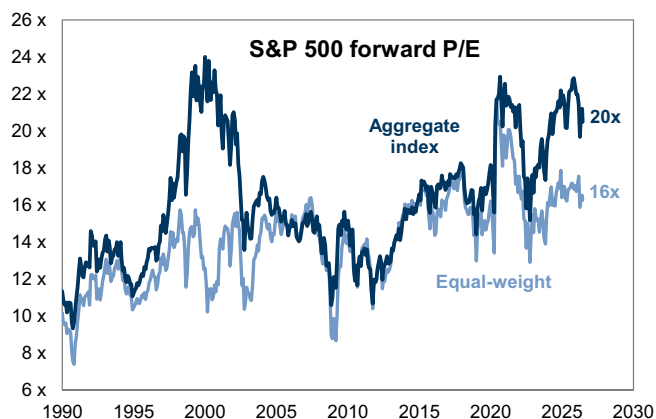
Valuations

Exhibit 45: US equity index P/E valuations vs. history



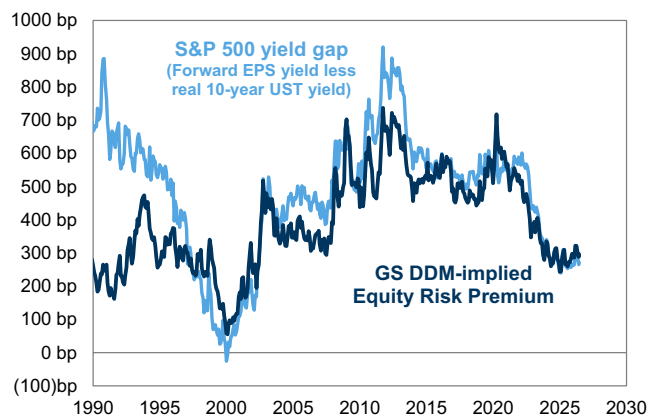
Source: Compustat, FactSet, IBES, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 46: S&P 500 consensus forward 12-month P/E



Source: Compustat, FactSet, IBES, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 47: S&P 500 valuation relative to US Treasury yields



Equity risk premium calculated by solving for the discount rate that equates the fair value of our multi-stage S&P 500 dividend discount model to the current market price and subtracting the 10-year US Treasury yield.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Sector returns, earnings, and valuations

Exhibit 48: Sector and industry group returns

			Top quartile						
			Bottom quartile						
S&P 500			Index weight	1 Week	1 Month	3 Months	Last 12 Mo	YTD	GS allocation
			100 %	(2.5)%	(0)%	9 %	24 %	9 %	
S E C T O R	Consumer Staples	5 %	3.7 %	1 %	1 %	8 %	11 %	OW	
	Health Care	9	1.4	8	1	16	(0)		
	Real Estate	2	1.2	1	7	15	16		
	Financials	12	0.8	3	7	5	(3)		
	Utilities	2	0.2	(2)	(4)	12	4	OW	
	Industrials	9	(0.5)	0	4	23	13		
	Materials	2	(0.9)	(2)	2	17	12		
	Consumer Discretionary	9	(1.7)	(5)	4	10	(2)		
	Energy	3	(2.8)	(0)	0	37	28		
	Communication Services	10	(3.8)	(6)	3	27	3		
Information Technology		37	(5.6)	0	22	43	17		
I N D U S T R Y G R O U P	Household & Personal Products	1 %	5.7 %	4 %	(2)%	(6)%	6 %		
	Food Beverage & Tobacco	2	3.8	2	4	10	13		
	Insurance	2	3.7	4	3	(2)	(2)		
	Consumer Durables & Apparel	0	3.5	6	(3)	0	(5)		
	Telecommunication Services	1	3.3	(4)	(12)	(8)	0		
	Consumer Staples Retail	2	2.6	(2)	(1)	14	11		
	Consumer Services	2	2.2	4	(1)	(2)	(4)		
	Banks	3	1.7	7	13	27	2		
	Pharma Biotech & Life Sciences	6	1.4	9	1	29	4		
	Transportation	1	1.4	6	11	26	14		
	Health Care Equipment & Services	3	1.3	6	1	(3)	(6)		
	Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs)	2	1.2	1	7	15	16		
	Utilities	2	0.2	(2)	(4)	12	4		
	Financial Services	7	(0.2)	1	5	(2)	(6)		
	Commercial & Professional Svcs	1	(0.8)	3	(7)	(23)	(12)		
	Capital Goods	7	(0.9)	(1)	4	32	17		
	Materials	2	(0.9)	(2)	2	17	12		
	Consumer Discretionary Retail	5	(2.2)	(6)	8	10	3		
	Energy	3	(2.8)	(0)	0	37	28		
	Semiconductors & Semi Equipment	18	(4.2)	(1)	34	89	39		
	Media & Entertainment	9	(4.4)	(7)	5	31	3		
	Automobiles & Components	2	(4.5)	(8)	(0)	25	(10)		
	Technology Hardware & Equipment	11	(5.0)	4	25	70	26		
	Software & Services	9	(9.3)	(1)	0	(17)	(17)		

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 49: Earnings contributions and growth by S&P 500 sector

Sector	GS top-down					Consensus bottom-up			
	Contribution			EPS growth		Contribution		EPS growth	
	2025	2026	2027	2026	2027	2026	2027	2026	2027
Info Tech	\$70	\$110	\$140	56 %	27 %	\$107	\$139	52 %	30 %
Financials	52	56	61	8	9	56	63	8	11
Comm Services	29	36	38	24	5	37	39	26	6
Health Care	33	34	39	2	14	34	40	1	19
Cons Discretionary	23	24	26	7	7	26	29	13	14
Industrials	21	23	25	9	9	23	28	9	19
Energy	12	19	17	60	(10)	19	18	62	(7)
Consumer Staples	15	15	16	4	4	15	17	4	8
Utilities	8	8	9	7	6	9	9	14	8
Materials	5	8	8	39	5	8	8	42	10
Real Estate	6	7	7	5	6	7	8	15	8
S&P 500	\$275	\$340	\$385	24 %	13 %	\$341	\$398	24 %	17 %

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 50: S&P 500 sector P/E valuations relative to history

	Consensus forward 12-month P/E valuation				
	Current P/E	Absolute P/E		P/E vs. S&P 500	
		%ile rank vs. history		%ile rank vs. history	
		10-year	30-year	10-year	30-year
Consumer Discretionary	26x	46%	81%	25%	71%
Industrials	25	86	95	97	99
Information Technology	23	55	62	53	42
Consumer Staples	22	85	85	56	35
S&P 500	20	56	76		
Communication Services	20	53	53	35	12
Real Estate	19	65	81	39	35
Health Care	18	74	66	39	19
Utilities	17	56	86	69	70
Materials	17	41	61	21	14
Financials	15	38	66	9	8
Energy	13	34	45	37	18

Source: Compustat, FactSet, IBES, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Thematic baskets

Exhibit 51: Recent performance of select Goldman Sachs Research baskets

basket returns expressed relative to the equal-weight S&P 500 except for long/short basket pairs as noted

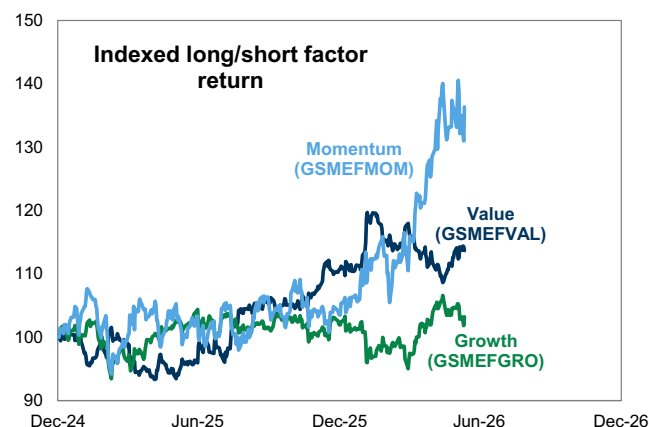
	Basket / Index	Ticker (GSTH_____)	Total returns			
			1 Wk	Top quartile		
				Bottom quartile		
				3 Mo	12 Mo	YTD
	S&P 500	SPX	(2.5)%	9 %	24 %	9 %
	Equal-weight S&P 500	SPW	(0.4)	7	19	10
Macro-economic	High vs. Low Tax Rate	HTAX / LTAX	2.6 %	(3)%	(1)%	2 %
	Interest Rate Sensitive	USTY	0.6	23	31	22
	Dual Beta	BETA	(1.1)	40	89	48
	Low vs. High Labor Cost	LLAB / HLAB	(1.2)	8	21	13
Geographic sales	US Sales	AINT	(0.4)%	5 %	(12)%	(4)%
	International Sales	INTL	(1.8)	27	48	32
	EM Sales	BRIC	(2.3)	39	82	52
	Western Europe Sales	WEUR	(4.6)	5	6	3
Fundamental	Strong vs. Weak Balance Sheet	SBAL / WBAL	2.8 %	(4)%	(20)%	(10)%
	High Quality	QUAL	(0.1)	(6)	(14)	(9)
	Stable Growers	STGR	(2.2)	(7)	(19)	(10)
	Long vs. Short Duration	LDUR / SDUR	(2.4)	(4)	(21)	(11)
	ROE Growth	GROE	(2.9)	21	41	31
	High vs. Low Operating Leverage	OPHI / OPLO	(3.5)	(0)	(9)	(5)
Uses of cash	Debt Reducers vs. Issuers	DRED / DISS	0.7 %	12 %	27 %	13 %
	Dividend Growth	DIVG	(1.9)	9	15	6
	Total Cash Return	CASH	(2.0)	9	13	5
	Buybacks	REPO	(2.2)	7	4	1
	Capex and R&D	CAPX	(4.1)	27	57	34
	High Growth Investment	HGIR	(4.9)	19	37	23
Ownership, risk & liquidity	Mutual Fund Over- vs. Underweights	MFOV / MFUW	3.2 %	(14)%	(31)%	(22)%
	Low vs. High Liquidity	LLIQ / HLIQ	2.6	(8)	(18)	(12)
	High Sharpe Ratio	SHRP	(1.8)	(7)	(19)	(10)
	Hedge Fund VIP	HVIP	(2.8)	9	13	5
Equity research	Oil Input Cost	GSRHOILX	7.6 %	(1)%	(11)%	(1)%
	SMB Exposure	GSRHSMBX	(1.5)	(1)	(21)	(12)
	Gov't Exposure	GSRHGOVT	(1.8)	(5)	15	(3)
	M&A Candidates	GSRHACQN	(2.8)	3	15	(8)

Basket returns and constituents can be accessed via GS Marquee or Bloomberg using the indicated tickers.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Factors

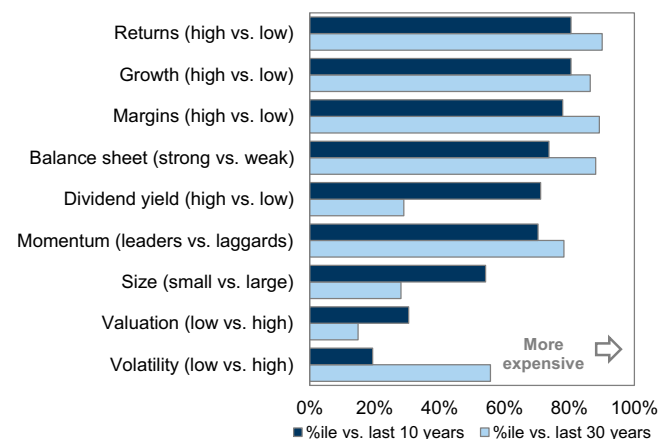
Exhibit 52: Indexed return of select equity factors



Factor performance and constituents can be viewed on GS Marquee or Bloomberg using the tickers indicated on the chart.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 53: Equity factor valuations relative to history



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Goldman Sachs global macro research cross-asset forecasts

Exhibit 54: Goldman Sachs macro research asset forecasts

Goldman Sachs Global Macro Forecasts

	units	Current	3m	6m	12m	Change to 12m target
Equities						
MXAPJ	level	856	980	1030	1080	26 %
TOPIX	level	3830	4100	4200	4400	15
S&P 500	level	7394	7600	8000	8300	12
STOXX Europe 600	level	622	640	645	660	6
10-year rates						
Euro Area (Germany)	%	2.5	3.0	3.0	3.0	55 bp
US	%	4.5	4.5	4.4	4.3	(15)
Japan	%	2.7	2.5	2.5	2.4	(27)
Corporate bonds						
Investment grade	bp	75	85	82	78	3 bp
High yield	bp	271	305	295	280	9
Currencies						
Euro / US dollar	EUR/\$	1.15	1.14	1.18	1.20	4 %
Sterling / US dollar	£/\$	1.33	1.33	1.34	1.33	0
US dollar / Yen	\$/¥	161	160	158	155	(3)
Commodities						
COMEX gold	\$/troy oz	4114	4805	4990	5445	32 %
NYMEX nat. gas	\$/mmBtu	3	3.50	3.50	3.50	13
LME copper	\$/mt	13420	13620	13735	13800	3
Brent crude oil	\$/bbl	90	92	88	80	(11)

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Ben Snider, Ryan Hammond, Jenny Ma, Daniel Chavez, Kartik Jayachandran and Christophe Sung, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views, which have not been influenced by considerations of the firm's business or client relationships.

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Contributing Authors: Ben Snider Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Ryan Hammond Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Jenny Ma Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Daniel Chavez Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Kartik Jayachandran Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Christophe Sung Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC.

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GLOBAL ECONOMICS ANALYST

The Path to 2075 — Is Convergence Really Over?

- Do poor economies grow faster than rich economies? Many economists argue that the evidence for convergence between low- and high-income economies is weak, suggesting that generalized convergence was largely confined to the ‘hyper-globalization’ decade of 2000–10. If true, this would be bad news for global well-being, and it would fundamentally weaken a key justification for long-term investment in emerging markets.
- We argue that previous studies that reported only limited evidence of convergence are incomplete, because they fail to weight countries by population size – effectively treating China and Cyprus’s experiences as equally significant. With this simple adjustment, we find that economic convergence has been a consistent feature of the global economy since the 1980s.
- The key drivers of this convergence have been Asia’s most populous nations: China (since the early 1980s), and India, Indonesia and Bangladesh (from the late 1990s onwards). Together, these four countries account for more than 40% of the global population.
- Among developed economies, the US has been an important positive outlier. Despite possessing one of the world’s highest levels of GDP per capita, its GDP per capita growth has continued to outpace most other developed markets.
- The contrast that we find with unweighted convergence studies suggests an intuitive point: periods of rapid globalization, such as 2000–10, are especially beneficial for the development of small economies with limited domestic markets. However, for large emerging market economies – especially those in East Asia – economic convergence appears relatively robust. This ongoing convergence implies that the share of global GDP represented by emerging markets (and East Asian EMs in particular) will continue to rise over time.
- Looking ahead, risks exist in both directions. The development of AI seems likely to bolster the strong performance of the US and parts of East Asia (in particular, China, South Korea and Taiwan). On the downside, increased protectionism could result in a reversal of globalization, while climate change poses a particular risk to Southern Asia and parts of Africa.

Kevin Daly
+44(20)7774-5908 | kevin.daly@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

The Path to 2075 — Is Convergence Really Over?

Economic Convergence, Led by Asia's Powerhouses

In this *Global Economics Analyst*, we review the performance of GDP per capita across 121 developed (DM) and emerging market (EM) economies since 1980, with a particular emphasis on the process of long-term economic convergence.

The principle of convergence – that poorer economies generally grow faster than richer economies over time – is a central assumption underpinning our *Path to 2075 projections* for the global economy (see Box 1).¹ The logic is that the marginal return on investment should be higher in poorer economies where capital is relatively scarce, which attracts investment, increases capital stock, and raises living standards.

We begin by outlining some key stylized facts about GDP per capita levels and growth rates across the world. *Exhibit 1* (left-hand side) depicts GDP per capita across various regions since 1980, while the right-hand panel presents the same data indexed to 1980. Several features stand out:

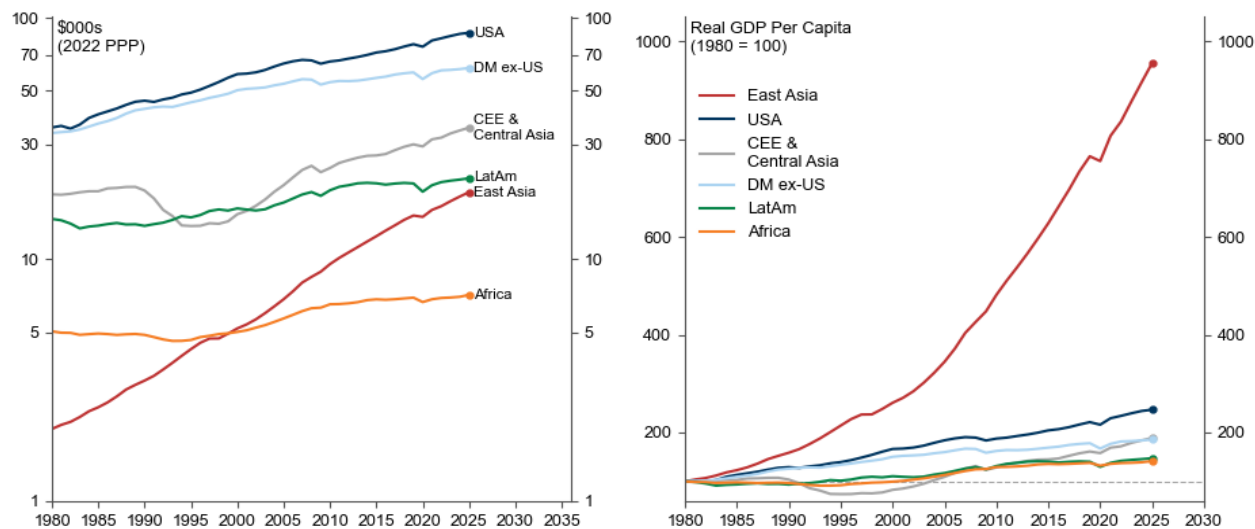
1. Cross-country differences in GDP per capita levels are large, even after adjusting for differences in purchasing power parity.² To take one striking example, GDP per person in the US is more than 12 times higher than the average across Africa.
2. East Asia's emerging markets have seen rapid GDP per capita growth, with average output per person now nearly 10 times higher than in 1980. However, GDP per capita in the region remains well below US and Western European levels, suggesting further potential for convergence.
3. US GDP per capita growth since 1980 has either matched or exceeded GDP per capita growth in the majority of other regions (with East Asia the only exception), despite having a much higher starting level of GDP per capita.
4. GDP per capita growth in Latin American and African economies has disappointed, averaging +0.9% and +0.8% per year respectively since 1980.
5. The break-up of the Soviet Union and the dissolution of the Eastern Bloc was initially very negative for GDP per capita in Eastern Europe and Central Asia in the early 1990s. However, GDP per capita levels have since rebounded in this region.

¹ “*The Path to 2075 — Slower Global Growth, But Convergence Remains Intact*”, Goldman Sachs Global Economics Paper, 6 December 2022.

² The choice between PPP weights and market weights depends on the comparison's purpose. PPP weights account for lower prices in poorer economies and better reflect welfare gains, while market weights show the Dollar value of each economy's GDP without adjusting for spending power. Since we are focused on income convergence, we use PPP weights. See “*How Fast Does the World Grow?*”, *GS Global Economics Analyst*, 27 October 2021.

Exhibit 1: GDP per Capita in East Asian EMs Has Risen Nearly Tenfold Since 1980, But Remains Well Below DM Levels

LHS: Real GDP Per Capita (\$000s log scale; 2022 PPP); RHS: Real GDP Per Capita (2022 PPP, 1980=100)



Regions are weighted by population size

Source: The Conference Board Total Economy Database™ (April 2026), Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

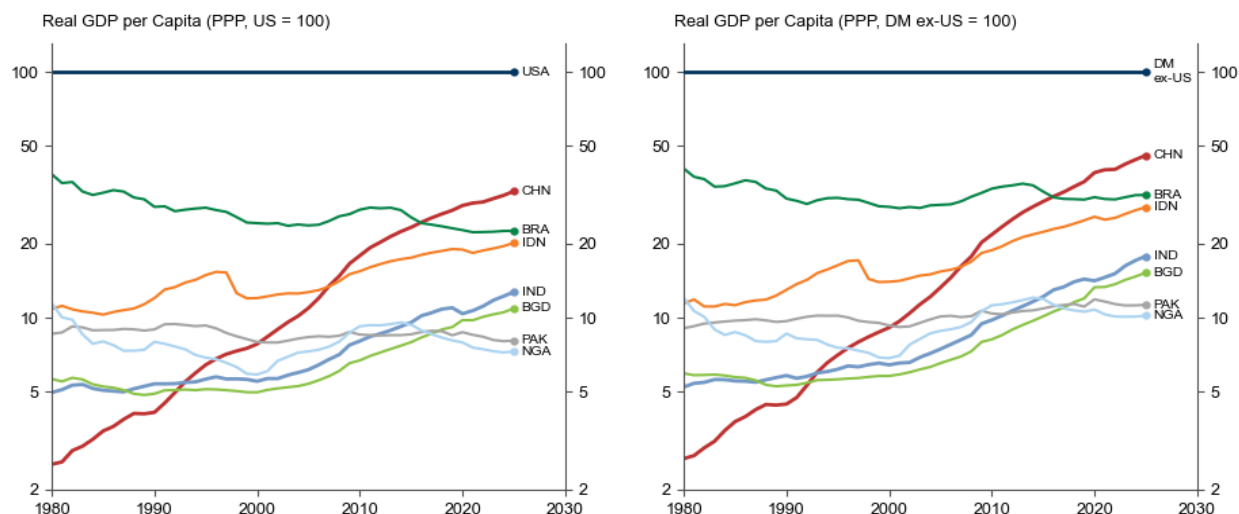
Exhibit 2 compares the GDP per capita of the eight most populous countries. The US is fixed as the ‘frontier economy’ in the left panel, while developed economies (excluding the US) are set as the benchmark in the right panel. China has seen significant income convergence, rising from just over 2% of US levels in 1980 to around 33% today. Since the late 1990s, India, Indonesia, and Bangladesh have also shown clear progress.

When compared to US GDP per capita, Brazil, Pakistan, and Nigeria have underperformed, with Brazil slipping further behind the US over time, while Pakistan and Nigeria have remained largely unchanged. However, as the US has shown particularly strong performance among developed markets, the relative picture shifts if we compare these economies to developed markets more broadly – Pakistan and Nigeria now show some convergence, whereas Brazil has remained more or less flat.³

³ The aim of this piece is to record, rather than explain, the convergence that has occurred. However, the question remains as to why the GDP per capita performance of Brazil, Pakistan and Nigeria has been disappointing. In Brazil's case, macroeconomic instability, high government spending crowding out private investment, significant trade barriers and inadequate infrastructure are all cited as contributing factors. For Pakistan and Nigeria, macroeconomic instability, elite capture and incomplete property rights are frequently mentioned.

Exhibit 2: China Has Converged Fastest Among the World's Most Populous States, But India, Indonesia and Bangladesh Are Also Converging

Real GDP Per Capita in 2022 PPP, log scale (LHS: US = 100, RHS: DM ex-US=100)



Source: The Conference Board Total Economy Database™ (April 2026), Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

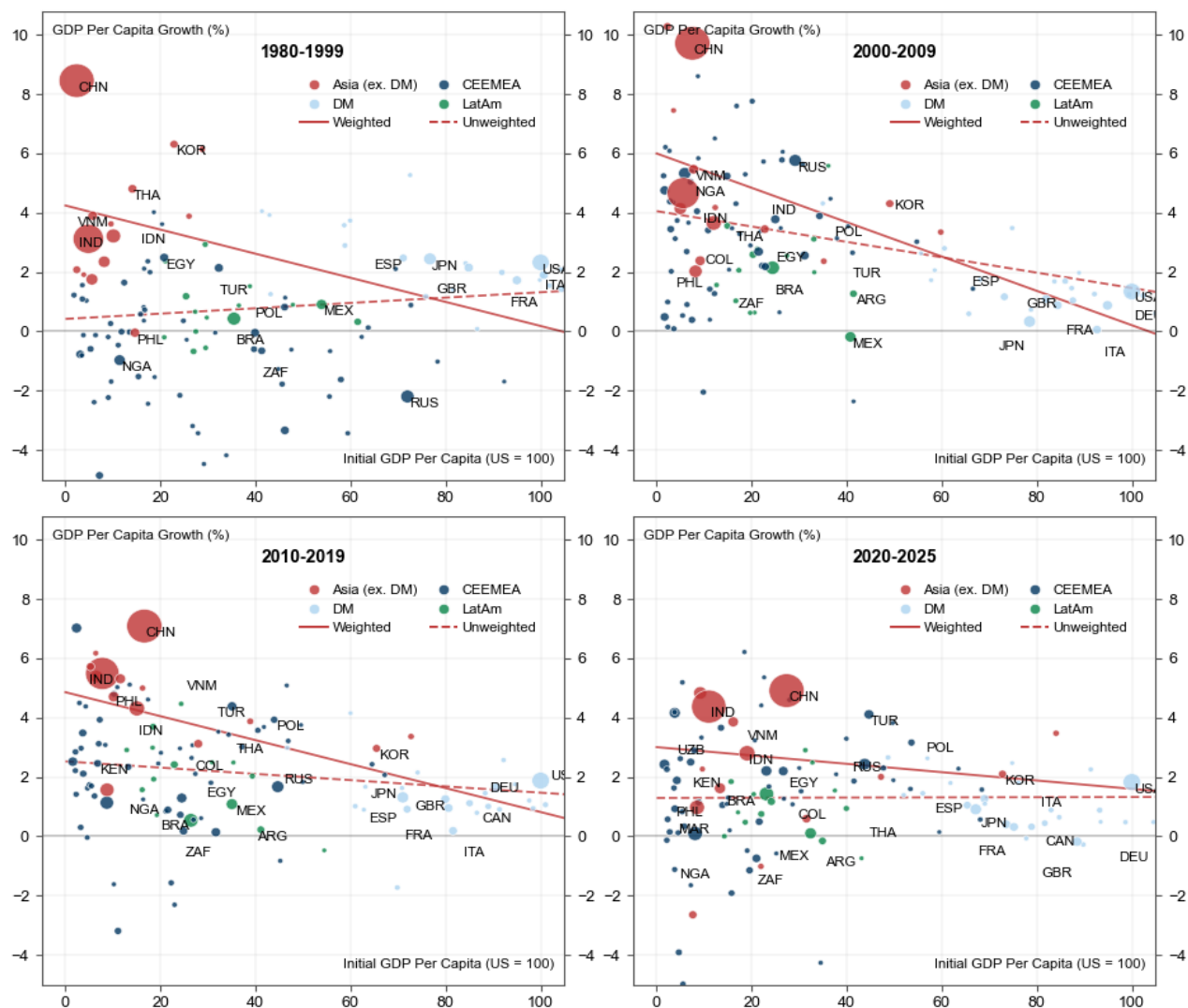
Population-Weighted Convergence is Reasonably Stable Across Decades

Exhibit 3 illustrates average GDP per capita growth in relation to initial GDP per capita levels for EM and DM economies across four distinct periods: 1980-1999, 2000-2009, 2010-2019, and 2020-2025. The level of GDP per capita is shown relative to the US (US = 100). We also show lines of best fit for all 121 economies on both a population-weighted and an unweighted basis.

Across all four periods, the population-weighted regression line slopes downwards, indicating that GDP per capita growth has been higher in low-income economies than in high-income economies (i.e., that there has been convergence). In contrast, the regression lines for unweighted countries are mixed, showing convergence in some periods but not in others. Moreover, the slope of the regression line is steeper for population-weighted countries in all four periods. Note that, although the performance of China and India is central to the narrative of population-weighted convergence – unsurprising given that together they comprise more than a third of the world's population – the regression lines continue to slope downwards from 2000 even when these two countries are excluded.

Exhibit 3: GDP per Capita Has Grown Faster in Low-Income Economies than in High-Income Economies

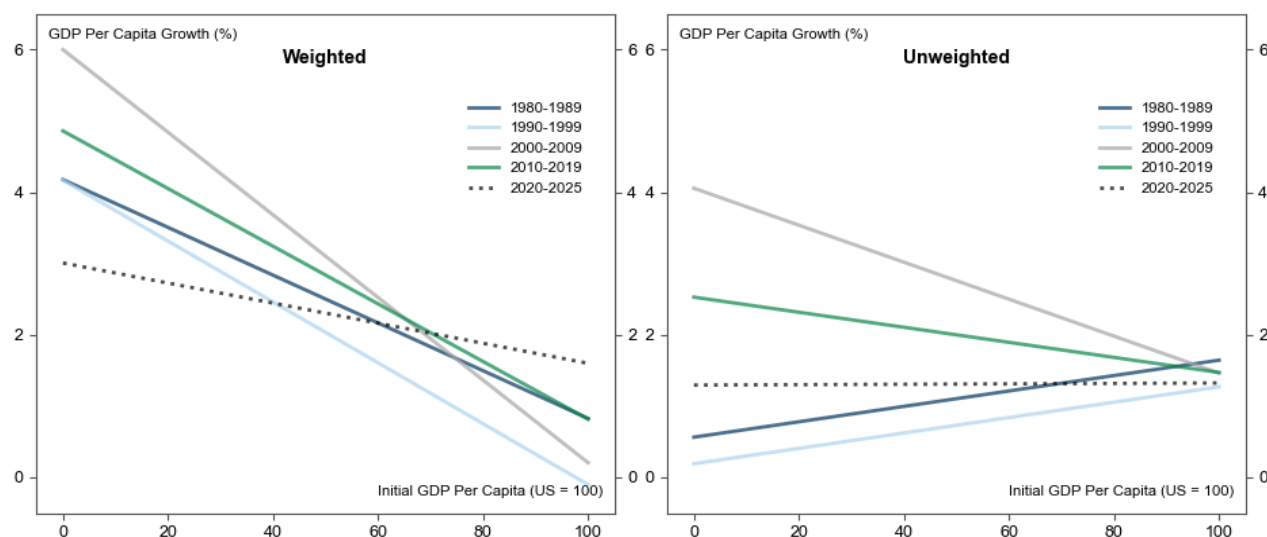
Real GDP Per Capita (PPP, %) vs Initial GDP Per Capita (US=100); Size of bubble = average population size



Source: The Conference Board Total Economy Database™ (April 2026), Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4 examines decade-by-decade changes in regression slopes. The population-weighted regressions show broadly similar slopes, except for 2020-2025, where the slope is still downward but less marked. The past half decade has seen a series of major shocks – the pandemic, the 2022 energy crisis, and 2025 US tariffs – and it remains to be seen how the slope will look for the decade as a whole. In comparison with the weighted lines, the regression slopes for countries on an unweighted basis display much greater variability.

Exhibit 4: GDP per Capita Growth Has Been Faster in Low-Income Economies in Every Decade on a Weighted Basis, But the Pattern is More Mixed on an Unweighted Basis
Population weighted vs unweighted fitted lines



Source: The Conference Board Total Economy Database™ (April 2026), Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

How rapid is this convergence? Since 2000, individuals in countries with a GDP per capita at 50% of the US level have, on average, experienced GDP per capita growth approximately 2.3pp higher than those in developed economies with productivity levels similar to the US.⁴ Over a 10-year period, GDP per capita levels for such individuals would have risen from 50% of US levels to around 61% of US levels.

How Our Results Compare with the Existing Growth Literature

On one level, our finding that the process of economic convergence is relatively robust and has been a consistent feature since the early 1980s should not be particularly surprising, as it is a central prediction of many economic models.⁵ However, the majority of cross-country studies have found little evidence that poor countries grow faster than rich ones, irrespective of other factors – in other words, there is little evidence of absolute or generalized convergence in the GDP per capita levels of countries over time.⁶

By making the simple adjustment of weighting each country by population size, our results suggest that convergence between poor and rich economies is a more robust feature than implied by previous studies of this type. **If the unit of aggregation is taken to be people, rather than countries – which is what population-weighting achieves – then convergence is alive and well.**

⁴ The slope of the regression line for 2000-2025 is around -0.05.

⁵ Standard (neo-classical) growth theory suggests that relatively poor, low-productivity economies should grow at a faster rate than relatively rich, high-productivity countries. This result follows directly from the assumption of diminishing marginal returns on capital: in developing economies where capital is limited, the returns on capital should be greater than in richer economies where capital is abundant. In turn, the relatively high returns on capital in less developed economies should attract investment, increasing the capital stock and raising living standards.

⁶ A key paper in this literature is Barro and Sala-i-Martin (1992), 'Convergence', *Journal of Political Economy*. Other studies found evidence of 'conditional' convergence – meaning that convergence occurs only when specific factors, such as institutional quality, are present. See Mankiw, Romer and Weil (1992) 'A Contribution to the Empirics of Economic Growth', *Quarterly Journal of Economics*.

We are not the first to adjust for population size in this way. Previous studies have also weighted by population size and, consistent with our findings, have found stronger evidence of convergence on this basis.⁷ Nonetheless, those studies maintain that, when assessing which economic policies drive growth and convergence, it is still reasonable to treat each country as an equal unit, since such policies are largely determined at the national level. We disagree for two reasons: First, economic welfare is a study of people, not nations, and if more people reside in some nations than others, they should be weighted accordingly. Second, a country's size is itself a potentially significant factor influencing growth and convergence. If larger countries tend to grow faster than smaller ones, this may partially be attributable to their size. Overlooking this aspect risks missing a potentially important determinant of growth.⁸

The contrast that we find with unweighted convergence studies suggests an important and intuitive point: periods of rapid globalization, such as 2000–10, tend to be particularly beneficial for the development of small economies with limited domestic markets. However, for large emerging market economies, economic convergence appears to be more resilient to the pace of globalization.

EM Growth Continues to Outstrip DM Growth by a Wide Margin

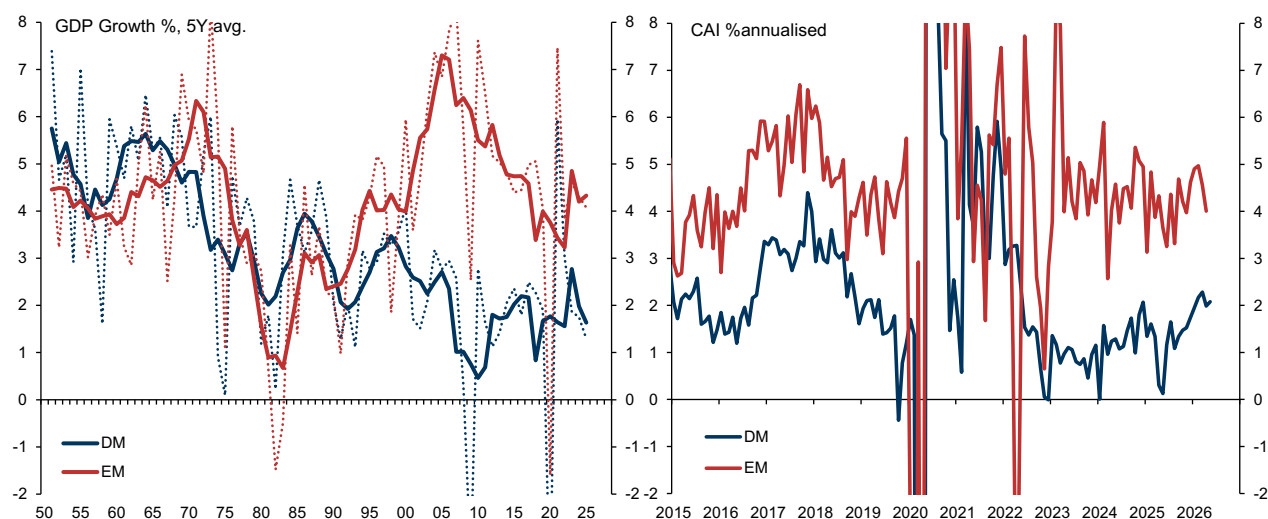
Our findings also explain why EMs consistently outgrow DM countries in our coverage – if convergence were not a fairly consistent feature of the global economy, this would not occur. While population growth is also higher in EMs, it does not fully explain the gap in potential growth rates (4.2% vs 1.6%). Moreover, in the four years since we published our *Path to 2075 long-term economic projections*, the gap between EM and DM growth has so far been larger than we expected (2.6pp vs. 2.0pp).

⁷ In a follow-up paper to Barro and Sala-i-Martin (1992)), Sala-i-Martin (2006) acknowledges that there is stronger evidence of convergence in income distribution at the level of the individual rather than the country but maintains that a country framework makes sense when evaluating which economic policies drive growth and convergence. See Sala-i-Martin (2006), 'The World Distribution of Income: Falling Poverty and... Convergence, Period', *Quarterly Journal of Economics*.

⁸ A large domestic market makes it easier to achieve economies of scale while still focused primarily on domestic demand, especially if industries are protected during their early stages of development. This strategy – protecting fledgling industries until they reach sufficient size – is less likely to succeed in countries with a small domestic market. There is also a related but distinct point concerning economic geography: large economies are able to support bigger cities and benefit from agglomeration effects, and economic convergence is often associated with rising urbanization and increased specialization. This is more difficult to achieve in small economies with small populations.

Exhibit 5: After a Brief Hiatus During the Pandemic, EM Economies Are Outgrowing DM Economies

LHS: GDP Growth (%; 5Y avg); RHS: Current Activity Indicator (% change, annualized)



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The ongoing convergence between (population-weighted) poor and rich economies implies that the incomes of EM economies will gradually move closer to those of developed economies – resulting in a further reduction in global income inequality – and that the share of global GDP represented by emerging markets will continue to increase over time.

Looking forward, there are both positive and negative risks to long-term economic growth and convergence. The development of AI seems likely to bolster the strong performance of the US and parts of South-East Asia and lift global GDP productivity growth more generally.⁹ In terms of AI-related capital expenditure, South Korea and Taiwan are already the main beneficiaries, while from a development and adoption standpoint, China seems well-placed to gain.

On the downside, we consider two risks especially significant: First, although global growth and trade have so far been surprisingly resilient to rising tariffs, increased protectionism could still trigger a reversal of globalization. Second, climate change represents a particular threat to Southern Asia and parts of Africa.

Kevin Daly and Alessa Abraham*

**Alessa is an intern in the CEEMEA economics team.*

⁹ For a discussion of the potential boost to EM productivity from AI and technology adoption more generally, see “EM Technology Adoption Cycles and Implications for Artificial Intelligence”, *Global Economics Comment*, 21 May 2026.

Box 1: The Path to 2075 — Long-Term Projections for the Global Economy

The Path to 2075 projections builds on our original BRICs analysis, offering long-term forecasts for the global economy, covering 104 countries out to the year 2075.¹⁰ Exhibit 6 provides a high-level summary of our projections for the major regional aggregates, broken down by decade.

Our projections imply that global growth in 2024-29 (2.8%) will be faster than in 2020-24, but slower than in the 2010-19 decade (3.2%, based on market FX weights).¹¹ We project that EM growth will continue to outstrip DM growth (3.8% vs. 1.8%), with around half of this difference due to demographic factors and the other half due to productivity growth differentials. We expect Asia (ex-DM) to remain the fastest-growing region.

Exhibit 6: A Gradual Slowdown in Global Economic Growth, With EM Growth Continuing to Outstrip DM

	Market FX Weighted								
	2000-2009	2010-2019	2020-2029	2024-2029	2030-2039	2040-2049	2050-2059	2060-2069	2070-2079
World	2.7	3.2	2.4	2.8	2.5	2.1	2.0	1.8	1.7
DM	1.6	1.9	1.5	1.8	1.6	1.4	1.3	1.2	1.1
EM	5.7	5.1	3.6	3.8	3.2	2.6	2.3	2.1	1.9
Asia (ex. DM)	7.6	6.7	4.1	4.2	3.1	2.4	2.1	1.8	1.5
CEEMEA	4.8	3.5	2.6	3.2	3.3	3.1	3.0	2.9	2.7
LatAm	2.8	2.4	2.3	3.0	3.1	2.7	2.3	1.9	1.6

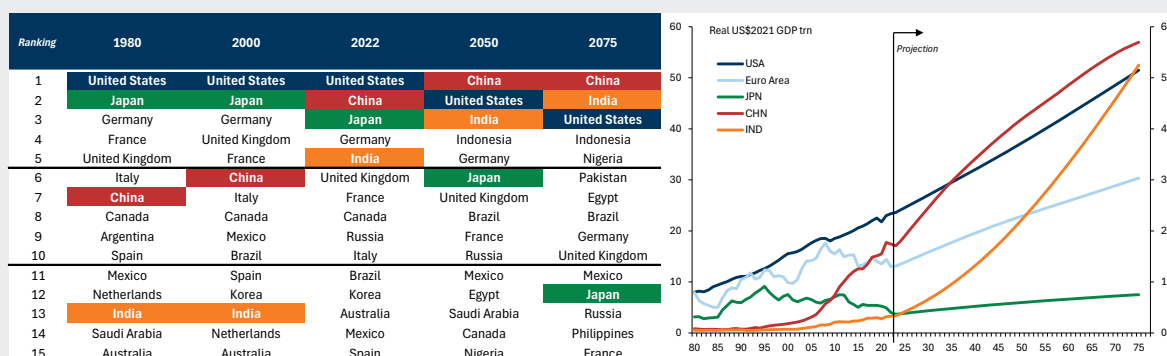
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7 combines our GDP estimates with our long-term real exchange rate projections, to project the real US Dollar value of major economies over time.

In 2050, we project that the world's five largest economies will be China, the US, India, Indonesia, and Germany (with Indonesia displacing Brazil and Russia among the list of largest EMs over this horizon). We estimate that China will overtake the US as the world's largest economy around 2035.¹² If we extend the projection horizon to 2075, the world's three largest economies are China, India, and the US, with India (just) overtaking the US. Interestingly, US potential GDP growth is expected to be materially faster than China's at that horizon because of its better demographic outlook. Given the right policies and institutions, we project that current EMs will make up seven of the world's top ten economies in 2075.

Exhibit 7: Our Projections Imply that China, the US, India, Indonesia, and Germany Will be the World's Five Largest Economies in 2050

World's largest economies (measured in USD)



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

¹⁰ "The Path to 2075 — Slower Global Growth, But Convergence Remains Intact", Goldman Sachs Global

Making economic projections over a 50-year horizon for 104 countries inevitably involves a considerable degree of risk and uncertainty. Indeed, given the difficulties in forecasting even one or two years ahead, some readers may be skeptical of the value of forecasts that extend so far into the future. However, one advantage of making long-term projections is that cyclical risk – an important source of short-term forecasting error – tends to mean-revert over time, leaving GDP mostly determined by slower-moving trends in population, capital, and technology.

Economics Paper, 6 December 2022.

¹¹ Because of the large swings in GDP growth generated by the Covid pandemic, the 2024-29 column provides the cleanest indication of what our model indicates for near-term potential growth.

¹² Given the recent pessimism around China's long-term growth prospects, some readers may be surprised that we expect China to overtake the US at this horizon. However, three points are worth bearing in mind in this regard: First, China has already closed most of the gap with US GDP (China's GDP has risen from 12% of the US in 2000 to around 80% currently, measured in market exchange rates). Second, despite significant downward revisions, potential growth in China remains significantly higher than in the US on our revised estimates (4.0% vs. 1.9% for 2024-29). Third, in addition to differences in potential growth, we expect some of the US Dollar's real overvaluation vs. the Chinese Yuan to be unwound over the next 10-15 years.

Box 2: Comparing Our Results Across Different Growth Databases

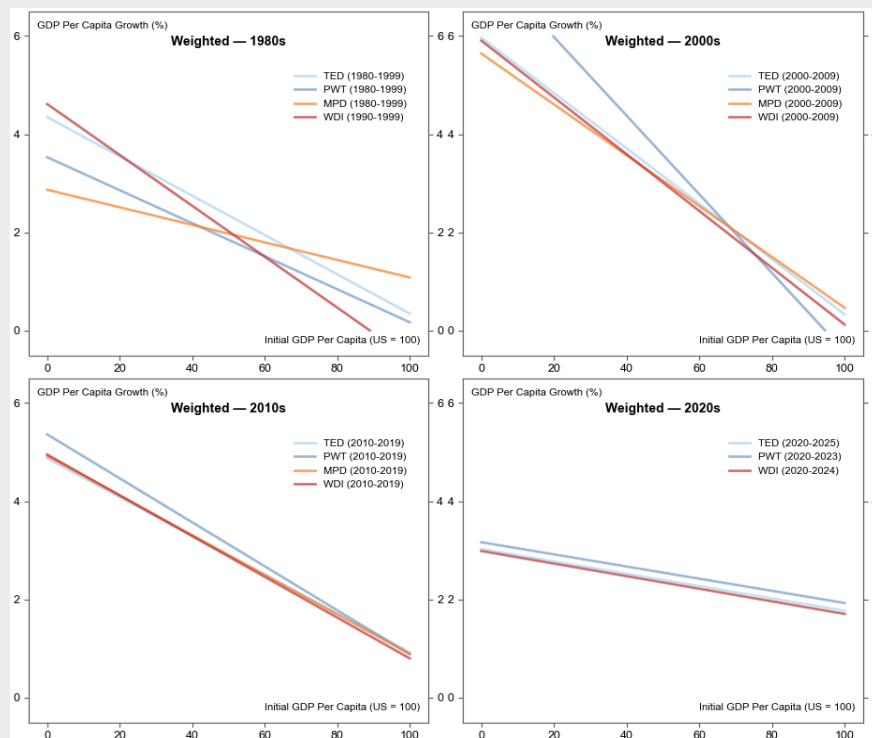
Growth and convergence studies typically use one of four different databases when analyzing long-term economic performance: World Development Indicators (WDI) by the World Bank, the Penn World Tables (PWT), the Maddison Project Database (MPD), and the Total Economy Database (TED) developed by the Conference Board. We generally use the Total Economy Database, partly because it provides the most up-to-date GDP figures. However, to cross-check our findings, we have replicated our analysis using each of these databases to ensure the robustness of our results.

Each of these databases possesses distinct advantages and limitations, making some more suitable than others depending on the research objectives. Among them, the Maddison database offers the most extensive historical coverage, in some cases reaching back centuries, making it ideal for studies in economic history. The World Bank's database has the shortest historical span, beginning only in 1990. Another key distinction is how they adjust GDP figures for differences in Purchasing Power Parity (PPP), which in turn impacts growth indicators.

The results of replicating our convergence analysis across each of the databases are presented in Exhibit 8. Although there are minor variations in the slopes of the fitted lines, the principal result—that weighted convergence persists—remains broadly consistent across all datasets.

Exhibit 8: Our Results Are Similar Across Each of the Main Growth Databases

Fitted lines - weighted by population, across the decades



Source: The Conference Board Total Economy Database™ (April 2026), Maddison Project Database (2020), Penn World Table 11.0, World Bank World Development Indicators, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The Global Economics Team

Jan Hatzius
+1(212)902-0394
jan.hatzius@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Joseph Briggs
+1(212)902-2163
joseph.briggs@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Sarah Dong
+1(212)357-9741
sarah.dong@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Megan Peters
+44(20)7051-2058
megan.l.peters@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

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